TABLES & HIGH-YIELD

Medieval India

Teaching tables, Confused Pairs, Common Traps, Current Affairs, and other high-yield blocks.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

Chapters

1. Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events
2. Topic 1 — Early Medieval India (Regional Kingdoms)
3. Topic 2 — Turkish Invasions & Delhi Sultanate
4. Topic 3 — Regional Kingdoms (Sharqi, Kashmir, Vijayanagara, Bahmani & Deccan)
5. Topic 4 — Bhakti & Sufi Movements
6. Topic 5 — Medieval Literature
7. Topic 7 — Mughal Empire
8. Topic 8 — Sher Shah Suri
9. Topic 9 — Rajputs
10. Topic 10 — Sikhism
11. Topic 11 — Marathas
12. Topic 12 — Later Medieval India
13. Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Kattyuri Dynasty
14. Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Parmar Dynasty of Garhwal
15. Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Chand Dynasty of Kumaon

Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events

Consolidated — 22 Must-Score Facts

1. Arab foothold: **Muhammad bin Qasim in Sind, 712 CE**.
2. Early medieval north: **Tripartite struggle** — Pala, Pratihara, Rashtrakuta for Kannauj.
3. Ghaznavid peak raid: **Somnath c. 1025–26** under Mahmud of Ghazni.
4. Ghurid conquest: **Tarain I 1191** (Prithviraj wins) → **Tarain II 1192** (Ghori wins).
5. Sultanate dynasties: **Slave** → **Khalji** → **Tughlaq** → **Sayyid** → **Lodi**.
6. Slave anchors: **Aibak 1206** → **Iltutmish** → **Razia** → **Balban**.
7. Khalji peak: **Alauddin Khalji 1296–1316** — markets, Chittor, Deccan (Malik Kafur).
8. Tughlaq traps: **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** experiments; **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** canals / taxes.
9. **1398** — Timur sacks Delhi.
10. South: **Vijayanagara 1336**; **Bahmani 1347**; **Talikota 1565**.
11. **1526** — First Battle of Panipat; Babur founds Mughal rule.
12. **1539 Chausa / 1540 Kannauj** — Sher Shah defeats Humayun.
13. **1555** Humayun returns; **1556** Second Battle of Panipat.
14. Akbar: **Haldighati 1576**; **Din-i-Ilahi 1582**; Fatehpur Sikri phase.
15. Jahangir **1605**; Shah Jahan **1628**; Aurangzeb **1658**.
16. **1674** — Shivaji's coronation at Raigad.
17. **1679** — Aurangzeb reimposes jizya.
18. **1686–87** — Bijapur and Golconda annexed.
19. **1699** — Khalsa founded by Guru Gobind Singh.
20. **1707** — Death of Aurangzeb.
21. Do not swap **Tarain I / II** or **Panipat I / II / III** (III is Modern 1761).
22. Do not swap **Shivaji coronation 1674** with **Khalsa 1699**.

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Tarain 1191	Tarain 1192	Prithviraj victory vs Ghori's decisive win	तराइन प्रथम / द्वितीय
Panipat 1526	Panipat 1556	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi / Akbar–Bairam vs Hemu	पानीपत प्रथम / द्वितीय
Babur	Humayun	Founder vs son who lost and regained Delhi	बाबर / हुमायूँ
Sher Shah	Islam Shah	Sur founder vs successor	शेरशाह / इस्लाम शाह
Akbar	Aurangzeb	Sulh-i-Kul / expansion vs orthodoxy / Deccan drain	अकबर / औरंगज़ेब
Shivaji 1674	Khalsa 1699	Maratha kingship vs Sikh Khalsa	शिवाजी / खालसा
Vijayanagara 1336	Bahmani 1347	Hindu southern empire vs Deccan sultanate	विजयनगर / बहमनी

M.0 Megaspine — memorise this first

Year	Event
712	Muhammad bin Qasim conquers Sind
1025–26	Mahmud of Ghazni's Somnath expedition
1191	First Battle of Tarain — Prithviraj defeats Ghori
1192	Second Battle of Tarain — Ghori defeats Prithviraj

Year	Event
1206	Qutbuddin Aibak founds the Delhi Sultanate
1290	Khalji dynasty begins
1320	Tughlaq dynasty begins
1398	Timur sacks Delhi
1451	Bahlul Lodi founds the Lodi dynasty
1526	First Battle of Panipat — Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi
1540	Sher Shah Suri ousts Humayun
1556	Second Battle of Panipat — Akbar's forces defeat Hemu
1565	Battle of Talikota — Deccan Sultanates defeat Vijayanagara
1674	Coronation of Shivaji at Raigad
1699	Foundation of the Khalsa
1707	Death of Aurangzeb

M.1 Early medieval India (c. 750–1200)

Year	Event
c. 750–1000	Tripartite struggle — Palas, Gurjara-Pratiharas and Rashtrakutas fight for Kannauj
c. 8th–12th cent.	Rise of Rajput polities in north and west India; temple-building phase
788	Traditional birth year of Adi Shankaracharya in many coaching keys
c. 800	Pala emperor Dharmapala patronises Vikramashila University
814–878	Amoghavarsha I of the Rashtrakutas — Kannada literature flourishes
836–885	Mihira Bhoja of the Pratiharas — peak of Pratihara power
985–1014	Rajaraja I expands Chola power; Brihadisvara Temple phase begins
1014–1044	Rajendra I — Gangaikonda Cholapuram; naval expedition to South-East Asia
c. 1000–1027	Mahmud of Ghazni's repeated Indian campaigns
1025–26	Mahmud of Ghazni plunders the Somnath temple
1175–1206	Muhammad Ghori's campaigns lay the base of Turkish rule in north India
1191	First Battle of Tarain — Prithviraj Chauhan defeats Muhammad Ghori
1192	Second Battle of Tarain — Muhammad Ghori defeats Prithviraj Chauhan
1192–1206	Ghurid officers (Aibak, Yildiz, Qabacha) consolidate north Indian conquests
1194	Battle of Chandawar — Ghori defeats Jayachandra of Kannauj (coaching key)

M.2 Delhi Sultanate — Slave & Khalji

Year	Event
1206	Qutbuddin Aibak founds the Slave (Mamluk) dynasty; begins Quwwat-ul-Islam / Qutb complex phase
1210–36	Iltutmish consolidates the Sultanate; silver tanka and copper jital; completes Qutb Minar
1221	Chinggis Khan's pressure on the north-west frontier during Iltutmish's reign
1236–40	Reign of Razia Sultan — first woman ruler of Delhi
1266–87	Ghiyasuddin Balban — strong monarchy, spy system, frontier defence against Mongols

Year	Event
1290	Jalaluddin Khalji founds the Khalji dynasty
1296–1316	Alauddin Khalji — market control, standing army, conquest of Gujarat, Ranthambhor, Chittor; Malik Kafur's Deccan raids
1301	Alauddin captures Ranthambhor; end of Chauhan hold there
1303	Siege and capture of Chittor by Alauddin Khalji
1309–11	Malik Kafur's southern campaigns against Warangal, Dwarasamudra and Madurai
1316–20	Succession crisis after Alauddin; end of Khalji power

M.3 Delhi Sultanate — Tughlaq, Sayyid & Lodi

Year	Event
1320	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq founds the Tughlaq dynasty
1325–51	Muhammad bin Tughlaq — capital shift Delhi–Daulatabad, token currency, Doab tax experiments
1327–34	Daulatabad as temporary capital phase
1333–34	Ibn Battuta arrives; later serves as Qazi of Delhi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq
1336	Foundation of the Vijayanagara Empire by Harihara and Bukka
1339	Shah Mir dynasty established in Kashmir
1347	Foundation of the Bahmani kingdom by Ala-ud-Din Bahman Shah
1351–88	Firoz Shah Tughlaq — canals, public works, jizya on Brahmins in many keys, new towns
1398	Timur invades and sacks Delhi — Sultanate authority collapses in the provinces
1414–51	Sayyid dynasty rules a reduced Delhi Sultanate
1451–89	Bahlul Lodi founds and consolidates the Lodi dynasty
1489–1517	Sikandar Lodi — Agra's rise as a second political centre
1517–26	Ibrahim Lodi — last Sultan of Delhi
1526	21 April — First Battle of Panipat; Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi; Delhi Sultanate ends

M.4 Regional kingdoms & Deccan

Year	Event
1336–1565	Vijayanagara Empire — Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva and Aravidu dynasties
1347–1527	Bahmani Sultanate; later breaks into five Deccan Sultanates
1394–1479	Sharqi kingdom of Jaunpur as a major cultural centre
1407	Muzaffar Shah establishes the Sultanate of Gujarat
1418–70	Zain-ul-Abidin's notable reign in Kashmir (coaching cultural tag)
1459	Rao Jodha founds Jodhpur
1490 onwards	Bahmani fragmentation — Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Berar, Bidar
1509–29	Krishnadevaraya of Vijayanagara — peak of the empire; Ashtadiggajas
1565	Battle of Talikota (Rakshasa-Tangadi) — Deccan Sultanates defeat Vijayanagara
c. 15th–16th cent.	Independent Bengal, Malwa and Gujarat sultanates in north–west coaching maps

M.5 Mughals — Babur to Humayun & Sur

Year	Event
1526	Babur founds the Mughal Empire after Panipat; occupies Delhi and Agra
1527	Battle of Khanwa — Babur defeats Rana Sanga
1528	Battle of Chanderi
1529	Battle of Ghagra — Babur defeats Afghan confederates
1530	Death of Babur; accession of Humayun
1539	Battle of Chausa — Sher Shah defeats Humayun
1540	Battle of Kannauj / Bilgram — Humayun loses India to Sher Shah
1540–45	Sher Shah Suri's reforms — rupiya, road–sarai network, administration, land survey
1545–55	Islam Shah and weak Sur successors
1555	Humayun recovers Delhi after the Battle of Sirhind
1556	Death of Humayun; accession of Akbar; 5 November — Second Battle of Panipat — Bairam Khan defeats Hemu

M.6 Akbar to Shah Jahan

Year	Event
1556–1605	Reign of Akbar
1562	Abolition of pilgrimage tax; early Sulh-i-Kul policy signals
1564	Abolition of jizya (first time under Akbar)
1571	Foundation / shift to Fatehpur Sikri as capital phase
1575	Battle of Tukaroi — Akbar's forces defeat the Bengal Afghans
1576	Battle of Haldighati — Mughal forces under Man Singh fight Maharana Pratap
1579–82	Mazhar / infallibility decree phase; Din-i-Ilahi promulgated in 1582
1580s–90s	Todar Mal's revenue reforms; mansabdari expansion; conquest of Gujarat, Bengal, Kashmir
1600	English East India Company chartered (link forward to Modern)
1605	Death of Akbar; accession of Jahangir
1611	Marriage of Jahangir and Nur Jahan; Nur Jahan's political influence begins
1615–19	Sir Thomas Roe at Jahangir's court
1627	Death of Jahangir
1628–58	Reign of Shah Jahan — peak of Mughal architecture
1632–53	Construction of the Taj Mahal at Agra
1639–48	Foundation and building of Shahjahanabad (Old Delhi)

M.7 Aurangzeb, Marathas & Sikhs (to 1707)

Year	Event
1658	War of Succession; Aurangzeb defeats Dara Shikoh and becomes emperor
1659	Execution of Dara Shikoh; consolidation of Aurangzeb's accession
1665	Treaty of Purandar between Shivaji and Jai Singh I
1666	Shivaji's escape from Agra (coaching narrative tag)

Year	Event
1674	Coronation of Shivaji as Chhatrapati at Raigad; Ashtapradhan council
1675	Execution of Guru Tegh Bahadur at Delhi
1679	Aurangzeb reimposes jizya
1680	Death of Shivaji; accession of Sambhaji
1681 onwards	Aurangzeb's long Deccan residence and Maratha war
1686	Annexation of Bijapur
1687	Annexation of Golconda
1689	Capture and execution of Sambhaji; Rajaram continues resistance
1699	Guru Gobind Singh founds the Khalsa at Anandpur Sahib
1700	Death of Rajaram; Tarabai leads Maratha resistance
1707	Death of Aurangzeb at Ahmadnagar; Bahadur Shah I's accession struggle begins — opens Modern Later Mughal chronology
1708	Death of Guru Gobind Singh (edge of Medieval / Modern overlap)

M.8 Bhakti–Sufi chronological anchors (select)

Year	Event
c. 12th cent.	Early Sufi silsilas take root in north India; Chishti and Suhrawardi presence
c. 1175–1260	Traditional span associated with Moinuddin Chishti of Ajmer in many keys
c. 13th–14th cent.	Nizamuddin Auliya and Amir Khusrau at Delhi
c. 1440–1518	Kabir's period (traditional)
1469–1539	Guru Nanak — foundation of Sikhism
1486–1534	Chaitanya Mahaprabhu — Gaudiya Vaishnavism in Bengal
c. 1532–1623	Tulsidas — Ramcharitmanas
1604	Compilation of the Adi Granth under Guru Arjan
1675–1708	Guru Gobind Singh — militarisation and Khalsa

Practice Zone — Arrange / Chronology Drill

> **15 high-yield chronology drill questions** | Core chronological markers of Medieval India | Comprehensive 3-part explanations

Common Traps

1. **Tarain I = Ghori wins** → Prithviraj wins 1191; Ghori wins 1192.
2. **Panipat I = Akbar** → Babur 1526; Akbar's is Panipat II 1556.
3. **Sher Shah after Akbar** → Sher Shah defeats Humayun before Akbar's consolidation.
4. **Shivaji crowned by Aurangzeb** → independent coronation at Raigad, 1674.
5. **Khalsa founded by Guru Nanak** → Guru Gobind Singh, 1699.
6. **Talikota = Mughal victory** → Deccan Sultanates vs Vijayanagara.
7. **Third Battle of Panipat = Medieval** → **1761**, Modern India.

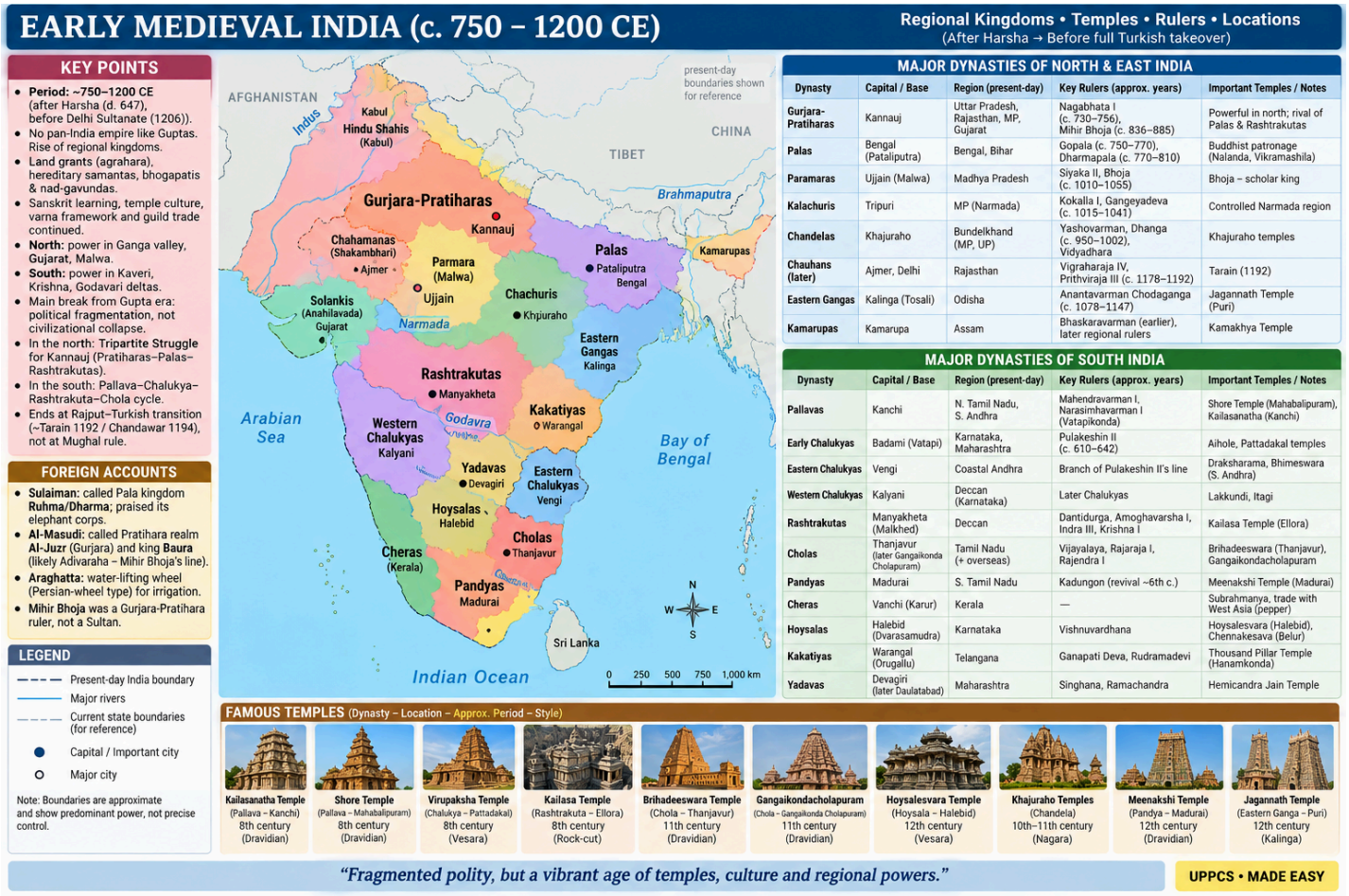
8. **Iltutmish founded Sultanate** → **Aibak 1206**; Iltutmish consolidated.

Topic 1 — Early Medieval India (Regional Kingdoms)

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Early Medieval	Delhi Sultanate	~750–1200 regional/feudal vs from **1206** Turkish rule	प्रारंभिक मध्यकाल / दिल्ली सल्तनत
Tripartite Struggle	South P-C-R-C cycle	Kannauj contest (Pala+Pratihara+Rashtrakuta) vs Tamil–Deccan power rotation	त्रिपक्षीय संघर्ष / दक्षिण चक्र
Pallava	Chola	**Kanchi**, pre-9th structural temples vs **Thanjavur** empire from Vijayalaya **850**	पल्लव / चोल
Early Chalukya	Western Chalukya	**Badami/Vatapi** (6th–8th) vs **Kalyani** (10th–12th)	प्राचीन चालुक्य / पश्चिमी चालुक्य
Ur	Sabha/Mahasabha	General village assembly vs Brahmana **agrahara** assembly	उर / सभा
Nadu	Mandalam	Basic unit (village cluster) vs province (empire had **4**)	नाडु / मंडलम
Mihir Bhoja	Bhoja I (Paramara)	**Pratihara**, title **Adivaraha**, Kannauj vs **Malwa/Dhara** scholar-king	मिहिर भोज / परमार भोज
Gahadavala	Pratihara	11th–12th Kannauj+Banaras Rajputs vs 8th–10th imperial Kannauj holders	गहड़वाल / गुर्जर-प्रतिहार
Chandela	Paramara	Bundelkhand/**Khajuraho**/Mahoba vs Malwa/**Dhara**	चंदेल / परमार
Devagiri	Warangal	**Yadava** (later Daulatabad) vs **Kakatiya** (Orugallu)	देवगिरी / वारंगल
Kannauj	Kanchi	UP sovereignty prize vs Tamil Pallava capital	कन्नौज / कांची
Shore Temple	Brihadishwara	Pallava Mahabalipuram ~7th vs Chola Rajaraja **1010** Tanjore	शोर मंदिर / बृहदीश्वर
Adivaraha	Gangaikondachola	Mihir Bhoja (Pratihara) vs Rajendra I (Chola)	आदिवराह / गंगैकोंडचोल
Vijayalaya	Rajaraja I	Imperial Chola **founder ~850** vs peak navy / Brihadishwara builder	विजयालय / राजराज
Rajaraja I (N. Lanka)	Rajendra I (whole Lanka)	Northern conquest vs full island + Mahendra V prisoner	राजराज / राजेन्द्र
Thotta Variyam	Eri Variyam	Gardens / horticulture vs tanks and water	तोट्टा / एरी
Eripatti	Taniyur	Tank-maintenance land vs large single-unit village	एरिपट्टी / तनियूर
Nataraja	Dakshinamurti	Four-armed dancing Shiva vs teacher form facing south	नटराज / दक्षिणामूर्ति
Badami / Vatapi	Vanavasi	Early Chalukya capital vs **Kadamba** capital	वातापी / वनवासी
Vengi (Pedavegi)	Rajahmundry	Eastern Chalukya capital **Pedavegi** near **Eluru** vs later seat **Rajamahendravaram**	वेंगी / राजमहेन्द्रवरम
Vanchi / Karur	Madurai	Chera capital vs Pandya capital	वंची / मदुरै
Tarain	Chandawar	**1192** Prithviraj vs **1194** Jay Chandra	तराइन / चंदावर
Mihir Bhoja (Pratihara)	Bhoja (Paramara)	Adivaraha / Kannauj vs Dhara scholar-king / Bhojshala	मिहिर भोज / परमार भोज
Jejakabhukti	Kaushambi	Ancient **Bundelkhand** vs doab city	जेजाकभुक्ति / कौशांबी
Vikramashila	Odantapuri	**Dharmapala** vs **Gopala** (Bihar seats)	विक्रमशिला / ओदन्तपुरी
Prithviraj Raso	Prithviraja Vijaya	Chand Bardai vs **Jayanaka**	पृथ्वीराज रासो / विजय
Hammir Raso	Hammira Mahakavya	**Sharangadeva** vs Nayachandra Suri epic	हम्मीर रासो / महाकाव्य
Rajasekhara	Hemadri / Vijnaneshwara	Pratihara court poet vs early medieval **jurists**	राजशेखर / हेमाद्रि–विज्ञानेश्वर

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Anhilwada	Dhara	Solanki capital vs Paramara capital	अणहिलवाड़ / धारा



1.2 Major Dynasties & Rulers of South India

Dynasty	Capital(s)	Region	Key rulers ()
Pallava	**Kanchi**	N. Tamil Nadu / S. Andhra	Mahendravarman I; Narasimhavarman I (**Vatapikonda**)
Early Chalukya	**Badami / Vatapi**	Karnataka–Maharashtra	**Pulakeshin II** (defeated Harsha; Aihole)
Eastern Chalukya	**Vengi** (**Pedavegi** near **Eluru**)	Coastal Andhra (Godavari–Krishna delta (डेल्टा))	**Vishnuvardhana** (branch of Pulakeshin II)
Western Chalukya	**Kalyani**	Deccan	Later Chalukyas; rivalry with Cholas
Rashtrakuta	**Manyakheta** (Malkhed)	Deccan	Dantidurga; **Amoghavarsha I**; Indra III; Krishna I (Ellora (एलोरा))
Chola	**Thanjavur**; later **Gangaikondacholapuram**	Tamil country + overseas	Vijayalaya; **Rajaraja I**; **Rajendra I**
Pandya	**Madurai**	S. Tamil Nadu	**Kadungon** (revival ~6th c.)
Chera	**Vanchi / Karuvur (Karur)**	Kerala coast	Pressured by Chola navy; pepper (काली मिर्च) trade
Hoysala	**Halebid / Dvarasamudra**	Karnataka	**Vishnuvardhana**; Hoysalesvara
Kakatiya	**Warangal** (Orugallu)	Telangana	Ganapati (गणपतिदेव) Deva; **Rudramadevi**

Dynasty	Capital(s)	Region	Key rulers ()
Yadava	**Devagiri** (later Daulatabad)	Maharashtra	Singhana; **Ramachandra**

North & East dynasties (same match-drill home)

Dynasty	Capital / base	Region	Key rulers ()
Pala	Bengal–Bihar seats; Kannauj episodic	East	**Gopala** (elected); **Dharmapala**; **Devapala**
Gurjara-Pratihara	**Bhinmal → Kannauj**	Rajasthan–UP–MP	Nagabhatta I; **Mihir Bhoja (Adivaraha)**; Mahendrapala I
Paramara	**Dhara** (earlier Ujjain)	Malwa	**Bhoja I** (scholar-king)
Chandela	**Khajuraho / Mahoba / Kalinjar**	Bundelkhand (**Jejakabhukti**)	**Dhanga**; **Vidyadhara**
Gahadavala	**Kannauj + Banaras**	Eastern UP doab (दोआब)	**Govind Chandra**; **Jay Chandra**
Kalachuri	**Tripuri** (Jabalpur belt)	Chedi / Dahala	**Gangeyadeva**; **Karna**
Sena	**Nadia** (Lakshman Sen)	Bengal	Hemant → Vijaya → Ballal → **Lakshman**
Chauhan (Chahamana)	**Ajmer** (later Delhi)	Rajasthan–Delhi corridor	**Vigraharaja IV**; **Prithviraj III**
Tomar	**Dhillika (Delhi)**	Delhi–Haryana	**Anangpal**
Solanki / Chaulukya	**Anhilwada**	Gujarat	**Mularaja I**; Jayasimha Siddharaja; **Kumarapala**

PYQs — South dynasties (match)

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q90) Match List-I (Ruling Dynasties) with List-II (Capitals):

List-I	List-II
A. Pallava	1. Warangal
B. Pandya	2. Kanchi
C. Yadava	3. Madura
D. Kakatiya	4. Devagiri

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 4 3 B. 2 3 4 1 C. 1 2 3 4 D. 2 4 3 1

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q121) Match List-I (Ruler) with List-II (Dynasty):

List-I	List-II
A. Mahendravarman I	1. Rashtrakuta
B. Kadungon	2. Pallava
C. Amoghavarsha I	3. Chola
D. Rajaraja I	4. Pandya

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A. 4 2 3 1 B. 2 4 1 3 C. 2 4 3 1 D. 4 2 1 3

1.4 Chalukya Dynasty & Western Chalukyas

Feature	Early (Badami)	Western (Kalyani)
Capital	**Badami / Vatapi**	**Kalyani**
Peak ruler	**Pulakeshin II**	Vikramaditya VI (high-water mark)
Main rival	**Pallavas**	**Cholas** (Vengi + Tungabhadra doab)
End	Overthrown by **Rashtrakutas** (**757**)	Pressed by Hoysalas, Yadavas, later Sultanate

PYQ — Western Chalukya vs Chola

1. Assertion (A): The **Western Chalukyas of Kalyani** repeatedly fought the **Cholas**.

Reason (R): Control of **Vengi** and the **Tungabhadra doab** was strategically valuable to both.

A. Both true, R explains A B. Both true, R not explanation C. A true, R false D. A false, R true

1.8 Chola Local Self-Government

Body / board	Who / meaning	Role
Ur	General village assembly	Ordinary (non-agrahara) villages
Sabha / Mahasabha	Brahmana assembly in **agrahara** villages	Higher autonomy; committee system
Variyam	Working committee of the Sabha	Supervised village executive work
Thotta Variyam (तोट्टा)	Garden / horticulture board	Gardens and groves
Samvatsara Variyam	Annual committee	Yearly oversight
Eri Variyam (एरी)	Tank committee	Lakes, tanks, water supply
Pon Variyam	Gold / finance committee	Precious metal and money matters

Term	Meaning
Eripatti	Land whose revenue was set apart for maintenance of the **village tank**
Taniyur	A **very large village** administered as a single unit (not "land gifted to one Brahmana")
Ghatika	A college generally attached to a temple

1.9 Chola Naval Power

Target	Ruler	Fact
Sri Lanka	Rajaraja I, then Rajendra I	Northern then full-island control; Mahendra V prisoner under Rajendra
Maldives	**Rajaraja I**	Western sea lanes
Chera fleet	**Rajaraja I**	Defeat at **Kandalloor**
Srivijaya / **Kadaram (Kedah)**	**Rajendra I, 1025**	Malay / Sumatra trade choke
China embassies / missions	Chola court	**1016, 1033, 1077** (72 traders under **Kulottunga I**, 1077)

1.11 Tripartite Struggle for Kannauj

Tripartite Struggle — Cause, Course, Result (overview)

Actor	Move
Dharmapala (Pala)	Occupied Kannauj and installed **Chakrayudha** as nominee
Mihir Bhoja (Pratihara)	Recovered Kannauj; held it as capital
Indra III (Rashtrakuta)	**Sacked Kannauj 915–918** and defeated **Mahipala**
Krishna III (Rashtrakuta)	Later northern raid **963** that further weakened Pratiharas

1.13 Sena Dynasty

Order (ascending)	Ruler	Fact
1	**Hemant Sen**	Starts the 2024 chain
2	**Vijaya Sen**	Defeated late Palas and consolidated Bengal
3	**Ballal Sen**	Compiled **Danasagara** on gifts; pushed Brahmanical orthodoxy
4	**Lakshman Sen**	Patronised **Jayadeva** (जयदेव); started **Lakshmana Samvat**; fled **Bakhtiyar Khalji (1204)**

1.21 Medieval Names of Cities of Uttar Pradesh

Modern / common	Medieval / classical name	Key fact
Kannauj	**Kanyakubja**; **Mahodaya / Mahodaya Shri / Nagar Mahoday Shri**	Harsha capital; tripartite prize; Mihir Bhoja / later Gahadavala
Ayodhya	**Saketa**	Ancient–medieval continuity in Awadh
Varanasi (वाराणसी)	**Kashi / Banaras / Avimukta**	Gahadavala secondary capital; sacred centre
Mahoba	**Mahotsava Nagar** (also Mahoba)	Chandela capital in Bundelkhand **UP**
Kalinjar	Kalanjar fort	Chandela stronghold, **Banda** district
Aligarh	**Koil**	Early medieval name for the Aligarh belt
Bundelkhand	**Jejakabhukti**	Chandela country — **not** Kaushambi

Common Traps — Don’t Fall For These

1. **Kannauj** is the UP tripartite and Gahadavala seat; do not confuse it with **Kanchi**, the Tamil Pallava capital.
2. **Mihir Bhoja** was the Gurjara-Pratihara ruler with the title **Adivaraha**; he is not **Bhoja I** of the Paramaras at **Dhara**.
3. **Brihadishwara (1010)** was built before **Gangaikondacholapuram (~1025)**; the father **Rajaraja I** preceded the son **Rajendra I**.
4. The **Shore Temple** belongs to the **Pallavas**, not the Cholas.
5. The **Tripartite Struggle** had exactly three main powers: Pala, Pratihara, and Rashtrakuta; the Cholas were not a Kannauj contestant.
6. Sena ruler order is **Hemant, Vijaya, Ballal, Lakshman (H-V-B-L)**, not alphabetical.
7. **Devagiri** is the Yadava capital and **Warangal** is the Kakatiya capital; never swap them.
8. **Gopala** was **elected** by chiefs; he was not a routine hereditary founder.
9. **Mahendravarman I** was a **Pallava** ruler, not a Chola.

10. **Kadungon** revived the **Pandyas**; he was not a Pallava or Chola fact.
11. **Manyakheta** was the **Rashtrakuta** capital, not a Pratihara or Chalukya capital.
12. **Khajuraho** belongs to the **Chandelas**, not the Paramaras or Pratiharas.
13. **Badami** was the Early Chalukya capital; **Kalyani** was the Western Chalukya capital; **Vengi** (**Pedavegi** near **Eluru**) was the Eastern Chalukya capital — not Rajahmundry as the primary identification.
14. **Ur** was the general village assembly; **Sabha** was the Brahmana **agrahara** assembly.
15. **Jay Chandra** died at **Chandawar in 1194**, not at Tarain in 1192.
16. **Kadaram** is **Kedah (Malaysia)**; the **1025** naval expedition against it was led by **Rajendra I**.
17. **Rajasekhara** served **Mahendrapala I** and **Mahipala I** at the Pratihara court, not Paramara **Bhoja I**.
18. **Rudramadevi** ruled the Kakatiyas and was recorded in inscriptions as **Rudradeva**.
19. **Agrahara** grants were **tax-free** villages, not heavily taxed Brahmana settlements.
20. **Chennakesava** is at **Belur (Hoysala)**; **Hoysalesvara** is at **Halebid**.
21. Imperial Chola founder is **Vijayalaya (~850)**, not Rajaraja or Parantaka; **Maduraikonda** = Parantaka I.
22. **Takkolam 949** = Rashtrakuta **Krishna III** vs Chola **Rajaditya** — not Pandya or Hoysala.
23. **Thotta Variyam** = gardens; **Eri** = tanks; **Pon** = gold — do not swap.
24. **Taniyur** ≠ Brahmadeya gift; it is a large single-unit village. **Eripatti** = tank-maintenance land.
25. **Nataraja** = four-handed dancing Shiva; **Dakshinamurti** = teacher facing south.
26. Northern Sri Lanka = **Rajaraja I**; whole island + Mahendra V = **Rajendra I**.
27. **72 traders to China (1077)** = **Kulottunga I**, not Rajendra alone.
28. **Chera capital ≠ Puducherry → Vanchi / Karuvur**. **Vanavasi** = Kadamba, not Chalukya.
29. **Motupalli** = Kakatiya port; Aihole names **Kalidasa** via Ravikirti's boast.
30. First standing Chola navy = **Rajaraja I**; "Chola Lake" / Chola Gangam = **Rajendra I**.
31. **Prithviraj Chauhan** = **Prithviraj III**; Delhi founder city **Dhillika** = **Tomar Anangpal**.
32. **Vikramashila / Somapura** = **Dharmapala**; **Odantapuri** = **Gopala**; Sailendra five villages = **Devapala**.
33. **Jejakabhukti ≠ Kaushambi** → Bundelkhand. **Alha–Udal** = Mahoba Chandela.
34. *Hammir Raso* ≠ Abdur Rehman → **Sharangadeva**. *Prithviraja Vijaya* = **Jayanaka**.
35. Jurists = Hemadri / Vijnaneshwara / Jimutavahana; **Rajasekhara is not** a jurist.
36. **Lakshmana Samvat** = **Lakshmana Sena**. **Kumaradevi's vihara** = **Sarnath**.
37. Paramara **Bhoja** ≠ Kalachuri **Gangeyadeva**. Bhojshala deity = **Saraswati**.
38. Solanki capital = **Anhilwada**; Kannauj = **Mahodaya / Mahodaya Shri**.
39. **Hiranyagarbha** = **Dantidurga**. **Araghatta** = irrigation waterwheel.
40. **Taxila** is **not** an early-medieval Pala learning centre beside Nalanda / Vikramashila / Odantapuri.

Topic 2 — Turkish Invasions & Delhi Sultanate

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Arabs	Turks	**Qasim 712** Sindh foothold vs Ghazni/Ghori north India	अरब / तुर्क
Ghaznavid	Ghurid	Mahmud raided; Ghori conquered and stayed	गज़नवी / गौर
Firdausi	Firishta	**Shahnama** (Mahmud's court) vs **Tarikh-i-Firishta** (Bijapur)	फिरदौसी / फरिश्ता
Tarain I	II	**1191** Prithviraj wins; **1192** Ghori wins	तराइन प्रथम / द्वितीय
Naika Devi	Prithviraj	Ghori's **first India defeat (1178 Abu)** vs Tarain **1191** win	नायका देवी / पृथ्वीराज
Tarain	Chandawar vs Panipat	1192 Prithviraj; **1194** Jaichand (**Firozabad/Yamuna**); **1526** Ibrahim Lodi	तराइन / चंदावर / पानीपत
Vidyadhar	other Chandelas	Only Chandela who **resisted Mahmud** (**1019–20**)	विद्याधर
Mamluk	Khalji	Turkish slave rulers **1206–1290** vs Turko-Afghan **1290+**	मामलूक / खिलजी
Aibak Lahore	Iltutmish Delhi	Aibak capital **Lahore**; Iltutmish first lasting **Delhi** capital	लाहौर / दिल्ली
Firuz	Ghiyasuddin on Qutub	**Firuz** repaired 4th/added 5th; **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** did not build it	कुतुब मीनार
Yalduz/Qabacha	Altunia	Iltutmish rivals vs Razia's **Bhatinda** rebel	अल्तुनिया
Devgiri	Warangal rulers	**Ramachandra** (Devgiri) vs **Prataparudra** (Warangal)	देवगिरि / वारंगल
Hazar-Dinari	Zafar Khan	**Malik Kafur** vs Mongol-martyr general	हजार दिनारी
Iqta	Khalsa	Assigned revenue to **Muqti** (not direct Sultan deposit) vs **crown** land; **Iltutmish** institutionalised Iqta; **Siyasatnama** = Muqti source	इक्ता / खालसा
Khalsa	Jagir (2025)	Direct Sultan land vs assigned noble land	खालसा / जागीर
Dagh	Chehra	Horse branding vs soldier descriptive roll (Alauddin)	दाग / चेहरा
Sijda	Paibos	Prostration vs kissing feet (Balban rituals)	सिजदा / पैबोस
Barani	Ibn Battuta	Sultanate historian vs Moroccan traveller (**Rihla**)	बरनी / इब्न बतूता
Qutub Minar	Alai Darwaza	Aibak/Iltutmish minar vs **Alauddin** gateway **1311**	कुतुब / अलाई दरवाज़ा
Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Firoz Shah	Experiments (Daulatabad, token, Amir-i-Kohi) vs canals, welfare, hereditary iqta	मुहम्मद बिन तुग़लक / फ़िरोज़ शाह
Amir-i-Kohi	Shahna-i-Mandi	Agriculture dept (Muhammad) vs market control (Alauddin)	आमिर-ए-कोही / शहना-ए-मंडी
Haqq-i-Sharb	Ghari/Charai	Firoz irrigation tax vs Alauddin house/grazing taxes	हक़-ए-शर्ब
Gulrukhi	Lakh Baksh	Sikandar Lodi's pen-name vs Aibak's generosity title	गुलरुखी
Token Currency (Bronze/Copper)	Tanka & Jital (Silver & Copper standard)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq (1329–30)** — UPPCS 2008 fact	टोकन मुद्रा
Sikandar Lodi	Ibrahim	**Agra** builder vs **Panipat 1526** last Sultan	सिकंदर / इब्राहिम
chakla	Sarkar	Between Subah and Pargana vs **Mughal** term trap	चकला / सरकार

2.2 Muhammad Ghori

Bakhtiyar Khalji — Bihar and Bengal (Cause, Course, Result)

Dynasty	Period	Key rulers
Slave (Mamluk)	**1206–1290**	Aibak → Iltutmish → Razia → Balban → **Kaiqubad** → **Kayumars** (last)
Khalji	**1290–1320**	Jalaluddin → **Alauddin** → Mubarak → Khusrau Khan
Tughlaq	**1320–1414**	Ghiyasuddin → **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** → **Firoz Shah**
Sayyid (सैयद)	**1414–1451**	Khizr Khan → Mubarak Shah → Muhammad Shah → Alam Shah
Lodi	**1451–1526**	Bahlul → **Sikandar (Agra)** → **Ibrahim**

2.5 Khalji Dynasty — Alauddin, Military & Mubarak

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Jalaluddin Khalji	1290–1296	Crowned at **Kilokhari**; killed by Alauddin at **Kara**
Alauddin Khalji	1296–1316	Market control, cash army, Mongol defence, expansion
Mubarak Shah	1316–1320	Declared himself **Khalifa**; relaxed Alauddin's rules
Khusrau Khan	1320	Hindu convert usurper; killed by **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**

Alauddin Khalji — rise and titles

Title / name	Meaning
Ali Gurshasp	Birth name
Alauddin Khalji	Throne name
Sikandar-i-Sani	Second Alexander
Amir-i-Tuzuk	Early court post under Jalaluddin

Military campaigns — chronology (★★★)

Year	Target	Commander / fact
~1299	**Jaisalmer**	Submitted before deeper Rajasthan push
1299	**Gujarat**	**Ulugh Khan** and **Nusrat Khan**; **Karnadeva**; **Malik Kafur** taken (later **Hazar-Dinari**)
1301	**Ranthambor**	**Hamirdeva**; **Nusrat Khan** killed
1303	**Chittor**	**Rana Ratan Singh**; **Jauhar** (जौहर); **Padmini** lore (**Padmavat** (पद्मावत), Jayasi, **1540**)
1303	**Warangal (first try)**	Kakatiya (काकतीय) **Prataparudra** defeated Alauddin's columns
1305	**Malwa**	**Mahalak Deva** defeated
1307–08	**Devgiri** (देवगिरि)	**Ramachandra Dev** submitted; titled **Rai (राई) Rayan**; given **Navsari**
1309–10	**Warangal**	**Prataparudra II** (प्रतापरुद्र); success under **Malik Kafur**
1311	**Madurai** (मदुरै)	Farthest south; Pandya capital looted
1312	**Devgiri again**	Against **Shankar Dev**, Ramachandra's son

Mongol frontier defence

- Repeated Mongol attacks in Alauddin's reign (**1297–1306** range).
- After **1306**, the **Ravi** (रावी) is keyed as the boundary between the Sultanate and the Mongols.
- Large **standing army**, **Siri Fort**, and victories such as **Kili** kept the Gangetic heartland secure.

- Market control and cash pay existed mainly to fund that army (Barani).

2.6 Tughlaq Dynasty

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (Ghazi Malik)	1320–1325	Defeated **Khusrau**; **Tughlaqabad** (तुगलकाबाद); early canals/farmer relief
Muhammad bin Tughlaq	1325–1351	Most learned; **Daulatabad**, token currency, **Amir-i-Kohi**
Firoz Shah Tughlaq (फिरोज शाह तुगलक)	1351–1388	Canals, **Haqq-i-Sharb**, welfare depts, Ashoka pillars
Nasiruddin Mahmud (last)	1394–1412	"Delhi to Palam"; **Timur 1398**; dynasty ends **1412/14**

2.7 Sayyid & Lodi Dynasties

Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451)

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Khizr Khan	1414–1421	Timur's nominee; ruled from **Multan–Delhi** belt
Mubarak Shah	1421–1434	Built **Mubarakabad** on the Yamuna
Muhammad Shah	1434–1445	Weak reign; noble factions
Alam Shah	1445–1451	Last Sayyid; abdicated to **Bahlul Lodi**

Lodi Dynasty (1451–1526)

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Bahlul Lodi	1451–1489	Afghan founder; annexed **Jaunpur Sharqi (जौनपुर शर्की) (1484)**
Sikandar Lodi	1489–1517	**Agra** centre; **Gazz-i-Sikandari** land measurement
Ibrahim Lodi	1517–1526	Last Sultan; alienated **Daulat Khan**; killed **Panipat** (पानीपत)

2.9 Delhi Sultanate Administration

Department	Head / role
Diwan-i-Wizarat (दीवान-ए-विज़ारत)	**Wazir** (वज़ीर) handled finance
Diwan-i-Arz (दीवान-ए-अर्ज़)	**Ariz-i-Mamalik** (आरिज़-ए-मुमालिक) handled the army
Diwan-i-Risalat (दीवान-ए-रसालत)	**Sadr** (सद्र) handled religious affairs / foreign appeals
Diwan-i-Insha (दीवान-ए-इंशा)	Handled state correspondence
Diwan-i-Tan (दीवान-ए-तन)	Managed **jagirs and salaries**
Mustarfi (मुस्तौफ़ी)	Audited income and expenditure
Mushrif (मुशरिफ़)	Maintained office **records**
Vakianvis (वाक़ियानवीस)	Kept the list of events and **firmans**
Khareetadar (खरीतादार)	**Despatched royal decrees**
Barid (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक)	Served as a **spy** in the intelligence network
Diwan-i-Mustakharaj (दीवान-ए-मुस्तख़राज)	Revenue arrears — **Alauddin**
Diwan-i-Riyasat (दीवान-ए-रियासत)	Market control — **Alauddin**
Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi (दीवान-ए-अमीर-ए-कोही)	Agriculture — **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**

Department	Head / role
Diwan-i-Khairat (दीवान-ए-ख़ैरात)	Charity — **Firoz**
Diwan-i-Bandagan (दीवान-ए-बंदगान)	Slaves — **Firoz**

2.10 Delhi Sultanate Revenue System

Term	Meaning
Iqta (इक्ता)	Revenue + military assignment to **Muqti / Wali** — not land ownership
Khalsa (ख़ालिसा)	**Crown/direct** land — revenue to Sultan's treasury
Jagir/Iqta (जागीर / इक्ता)	Assigned to nobles — **not** direct state control
Kharaj (ख़राज)	Land revenue from peasants
Khams (ख़म्स)	**1/5** of war booty to Sultan
Jizya (जज़िया)	Poll tax on **non-Muslims** in lieu of military service
Jarib (जरीब)	Measuring rope / chain — **not** a tax type
Haqq-i-Sharb (हक़्क़-ए-शर्ब)	Irrigation tax — **Firoz** (~1/10 produce)
Zakat (ज़कात)	Religious alms/property levy (Islamic)
Fawazil (फ़वाज़िल)	Surplus paid by **iqtadar** to the centre

2.11 Delhi Sultanate Literature

Work	Author	Fact
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	**Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani**	Early Sultanate chronicle from Ghaznavid times to Nasiruddin Mahmud's age
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	**Ziauddin Barani**	From Balban to early Firuz; political ethics as well as narrative
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi (separate)	**Shams-i-Siraj Afif**	Full reign of **Firoz Shah**; do not merge with Barani
Tughlaqnama	**Amir Khusrau** (Barani tradition also linked in keys)	**NOT** Ibn Battuta
Fatawa-i-Jahandari	**Barani**	Mirror-for-princes advice on kingship
Rihla / Kitab-ul-Rihla	**Ibn Battuta**	Travelogue at Muhammad bin Tughlaq's court; best source on the postal system
Khazain-ul-Futuh	**Amir Khusrau**	Alauddin's campaigns
Qiran-us-Sadain	Amir Khusrau	Meeting of Bughra Khan and Kaiqubad
Nuh Sipihr	Amir Khusrau	Praise of India under Qutbuddin Mubarak
Rag Vibodh	Somnath	Music / raga (राग) treatise (1609)
Khaliq-e-Bari	Amir Khusrau	Hindavi vocabulary / lexicon
Fawaid-ul-Fuad	Amir Hasan Sijzi	Conversations of **Nizamuddin Auliya**
Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi	**Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi**	Valuable for later Tughlaqs / early Sayyids and the post-Timur phase

2.12 Delhi Sultanate Architecture

Monument	Builder	Fact
Quwwat-ul-Islam	**Aibak**, Delhi	Reused temple material; iron pillar (लौह स्तंभ)
Qutub Minar	**Aibak** started, **Iltutmish** completed	73 m; Firuz repaired
Adhai Din Ka Jhopra	**Aibak**, Ajmer	Seven-arched screen
Alai Darwaza (1311)	**Alauddin Khalji**	Domed gateway at Qutb (कुतुब) complex
Siri Fort	Alauddin	Mongol defence
Sultan Garhi (1229)	**Iltutmish**	First Islamic tomb in India
Jamat Khana Masjid	**Alauddin**	Nizamuddin area
Red Palace / Kushk-i-Lal	**Balban**	
Tughlaqabad	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq	
Hauz Khas	Firoz Shah Tughlaq	

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

1. First successful Muslim invader = Arab **Muhammad bin Qasim (712, Sindh / Dahir / Chachnama / Arod)** — not Mahmud or Ghori.
2. **Mahmud of Ghazni raided and withdrew**; **Muhammad Ghori conquered and stayed**. That is the Ghaznavid vs Ghurid difference.
3. **Firdausi** wrote **Shahnama** (Mahmud's court); **Firishta** wrote **Tarikh-i-Firishta** for Bijapur — never swap.
4. Ghori's **first defeat in India** = **Naika Devi / Mularaja II near Mount Abu (1178)** — not First Tarain (**1191**, Prithviraj win).
5. **Second Tarain (1192)** founded lasting Turkish power; **Chandawar (1194)** killed **Jayachandra** at **Firozabad / Yamuna**.
6. **Ghori** coins show **Lakshmi + Kalma**; **Mahmud** issued bilingual **Arabic–Sanskrit** silver.
7. **Bakhtiyar Khalji** took Bihar–Bengal (**Odantapuri, Nalanda, Vikramshila, Nadia, Lakhnauti**) — not Aibak.
8. The Delhi Sultanate begins in **1206** when Aibak took the title of Sultan, not in **1192** when Ghori won Tarain.
9. **Iltutmish** was the real consolidator of the Sultanate, not Aibak.
10. **Hamida Banu Begum** was **Humayun's** wife, not Alauddin Khalji's.
11. **Tughlaqnama** was written by **Ziauddin Barani**, not Ibn Battuta.
12. **Iqta revenue** went to the Muqti first and was **not deposited directly** in the Sultan's treasury. First Ghori-era iqta charge in India goes to **Aibak (Kuhram–Samana)**.
13. **Jagirs** were assigned noble land; **Khalsa** was direct crown land.
14. Balban's centralisation against the nobles is **not fully explained** by Mongol frontier policy alone.
15. Alauddin's conquest order is **Gujarat → Ranthambor → Chittor → Warangal**.
16. **Qutub Minar** was built by **Aibak/Iltutmish**; **Alai Darwaza** was built by **Alauddin**.
17. **Sikandar Lodi** made **Agra** important; **Ibrahim Lodi** was the last Sultan at Panipat.
18. **Chakla** is a Sultanate unit between Subah and Pargana; it is **not the Mughal Sarkar**.
19. **Jarib** is a **measuring rope**, not a tax.
20. **Khareetadar** despatched royal decrees; **Barid** was the spy.
21. **First Panipat (1526)** is Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi; **Second Panipat (1556)** is Akbar vs Hemu.
22. **Vidyadhar** is the Chandela who resisted Mahmud (**1019–20**); Somnath raid under **Bhimdev I**, who rebuilt the temple.
23. **Aibak** never took the title **Sultan** (**Malik/Sipahsalar** only); capital **Lahore**; death by **Chaugan**.

24. **Iltutmish** = Delhi capital, **tanka/jital**, Caliph **khilat 1229**, refused **Mingburni**; rivals ≠ **Altunia**.
25. **Balban** = **Blood and Iron**, **Zil-i-Ilahi**, **Nawruz**, **Diwan-i-Arz** — he did **not** invent **iqta**.
26. **Malik Kafur** = **Hazar-Dinari**; Deccan = plunder not full annexation; **Mubarak** alone declared himself **Khalifa**.
27. After **1306**, Mongol–Sultanate line keyed on the **Ravi**; **Ghari/Charai** and **PDS** are Alauddin facts.
28. **Ghazi Malik** founded the **Tughlaq** line; longest dynasty span = **Tughlaq**; **Timur 1398** under **Nasiruddin Mahmud**.
29. **Token currency / Daulatabad / Amir-i-Kohi / Holi** = **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**; **Rihla** = Ibn Battuta (Morocco), not Tughlaqnama.
30. **Firoz** = canals + **Haqq-i-Sharb**, **Diwan-i-Khairat/Bandagan**, **Dar-ul-Shafa**, Haj from treasury, Ashoka pillars (**Topra/Meerut**), Nagarkot translator **Azizuddin Khan** (not Mulla Abdul Baqi).
31. **Sikandar Lodi** = **Agra (1504)**, **Gulrukhi**, **Gaj-i-Sikandari**, abolished grain zakat; **Ibrahim** = **Khatoli 1518** + **Panipat 1526**.

Topic 3 — Regional Kingdoms (Sharqi, Kashmir, Vijayanagara, Bahmani & Deccan)

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Firuz city (Jaunpur)	Sharqi state (Jaunpur)	City named for **Jauna Khan**; independent state by **Malik Sarwar**	फ़िरोज़ नगर / शर्की राज्य
Yusuf Adil Shah	Malik Ahmad	**Bijapur** founder vs **Ahmadnagar** founder	यूसुफ आदिल / मलिक अहमद
Sharqi architecture	Delhi Sultanate architecture	Jaunpur massive gateways/arches vs Delhi arch-dome-minaret idiom	शर्की स्थापत्य / सल्तनत स्थापत्य
Zain-ul-Abidin	Sikandar Shah (Kashmir)	Bud Shah abolished jaziya vs temple destruction phase	ज़ैन-उल-आबिदीन / सिकंदर शाह
Vijayanagara Empire	Bahmani Kingdom	Hindu south empire vs first major Deccan Muslim kingdom	विजयनगर / बहमनी
Krishnadevaraya	Rama Raya	Tuluva peak (1509–29) vs regent killed Talikota 1565	कृष्णदेवराय / राम राय
Gulbarga & Bidar	Bijapur	Bahmani capitals (Gulbarga early, Bidar later) vs **Adil Shahi** centre	गुलबर्गा-बीदर / बीजापुर
Riyaz-us-Salatin	Riyaz-ul-Insha	**Bengal** history vs **Gawan's letters**	रियाज़-उस-सलातीन / रियाज़-उल-इंशा
Tin Darwaza (Bidar)	Teen Darwaza (Ahmedabad)	**Bidar Fort** gate vs **Ahmedabad** monumental triple gateway	तीन दरवाज़ा (बीदर) / तीन दरवाज़ा (अहमदाबाद)
Battle of Talikota (1565)	Battle of Raichur (1520)	1565 defeat vs 1520 Krishnadevaraya victory	तालीकोटा (1565) / रायचूर (1520)
Kitab-i-Nauras	Amuktamalyada	Ibrahim Adil Shah II (Bijapur) vs Krishnadevaraya (Telugu)	किताब-ए-नौरस / अमुक्तमाल्यद
Nayankara system	Iqta system	Vijayanagara nayaka military land grants vs Delhi Sultanate muqti	नायककारा / इक्ता

3.3 Vijayanagara Empire

Dynasty	Key rulers	Period
Sangama	Harihara I, Bukka I, Deva Raya II	1336–1485
Saluva	Saluva Narasimha	1485–1505
Tuluva	**Krishnadevaraya**, Achyuta Raya	1505–1570
Aravidu	Tirumala, Venkata II	1570–1646

Administration

Office / unit	Function
Mahapradhana	Prime minister; headed the central council
Dandanayaka	Law, order, and military coordination
Rajya	Province under a governor
Nadu (नाडु)	District cluster below the province
Ur	Ordinary village assembly

Office / unit	Function
Sabha (सभा)	Brahmana (ब्राह्मण) **agrahara** assembly with stronger autonomy
Nayaka (नायक)	Feudatory holder of an **amaram** grant
Amaram	Land grant tied to military service

3.4 Bahmani Kingdom

Sultan chronology

Sultan	Period	Fact
Alauddin Bahman Shah (Hasan Gangu)	1347–1358	Founder at Gulbarga
Muhammad Shah I	1358–1375	Early consolidation
Firoz Shah (फ़िरोज़ शाह) Bahmani	1397–1422	Pre-Bidar phase
Ahmad Shah I Wali	1422–1436	Capital shift to **Bidar**
Muhammad Shah III	1463–1482	**Mahmud Gawan** as wazir
Kalimullah	Last sultan	Kingdom split **1518**

Administration

Office	Function
Wazir	Prime minister and head of civil administration
Mustaufi	Finance minister; accounts and audit
Mir Jumla	Foreign trade (पण्याध्यक्ष), customs, and commercial revenue
Tarafdar	Governor of a **taraf** (province)
Kotwal	City administration and law and order
Barid (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक)	Intelligence service and news reporting
Ariz	Military department; army rolls and pay

Literary and historical sources

Work	What it is	Key fact
Riyaz-ul-Insha	Collection of **Mahmud Gawan's letters and state papers**	Bahmani administration; **not** Bengal history
Riyaz-us-Salatin	History of **Bengal**	Trap: sounds like Riyaz-ul-Insha but is a **different book**
Burhan-e-Masir	Chronicle of **Ahmadnagar**	Nizam Shahi successor state, not Bahmani court letters
Mirat-e-Sikandari	**Gujarat** victory narrative	Regional history; match with Gujarat

3.5 Deccan Sultanates

Sultanate	Dynasty	Founder	Capital	Period
Bijapur (बीजापुर)	Adil Shahi	**Yusuf Adil Shah** (यूसुफ आदिल)	Bijapur	1490–1686
Golkonda	Qutb Shahi	**Quli Qutb Shah**	Golkonda → Hyderabad	1518–1687
Ahmadnagar	Nizam Shahi	**Malik Ahmad** (मलिक अहमद)	Ahmadnagar	1490–1636

Sultanate	Dynasty	Founder	Capital	Period
Bidar	Barid Shahi	**Amir Barid**	Bidar	1492–1619
Berar	Imad Shahi	**Fathullah Imad-ul-Mulk**	Ellichpur	1490–1574

Common administrative pattern

Element	Function
Wazir / Peshwa (पेशवा)	Chief minister
Pargana (परगना)	Basic revenue-admin unit
Amil / Desai (आमिल)	Revenue collector
Qazi (क़ाज़ी)	Judge under Islamic law
Kotwal	City police and order

Literary works of the Deccan Sultanates

Work	Author / state	Key fact
Kitab-i-Nauras	**Ibrahim Adil Shah II** of **Bijapur**	Musical-devotional songs; **not** Krishnadevaraya
Burhan-e-Masir	Court chronicle of **Ahmadnagar**	Nizam Shahi history
Amuktamalyada	**Krishnadevaraya** of Vijayanagara	Telugu epic — cross-trap with Kitab-i-Nauras

3.7 Master Fact-Locks — Medieval Geography, Regional Architecture & Polygars

Topic / Category	Entity / Detail	Region / Present State / Notes
Medieval State	**Champaka (Chamba)**	Himachal Pradesh (Rajput state emerging post-Tripartite struggle)
Medieval State	**Kuluta (Kullu)**	Himachal Pradesh (Rajput state emerging post-Tripartite struggle)
Medieval State	**Durgara**	Jammu & Kashmir (Rajput state)
South Indian Feudalism	**Polygars (Palaiyakkarar)**	Territorial administrative & military governors appointed by **Nayaka rulers** of South India (16th–18th c.)
Mandu (Malwa)	**Jahaj Mahal**	Built by **Ghiyasuddin Khalji** in Mandu (*Exam Clarification:* NO 'Jantar Mahal' exists in Mandu)
Bengal Architecture	**Adina Masjid**	Located at **Pandua**, West Bengal; built by Sultan **Sikandar Shah** (1364–1374 CE)
Bengal Architecture	**Qadam Rasul**	Built by Sultan **Nusrat Shah** at Gaur
Bengal Architecture	**Chhota Sona Masjid**	Built by **Wali Muhammad** at Gaur
Gujarat Architecture	**Tin Darwaza**	Triple-arched ceremonial gate in Ahmedabad built by **Ahmad Shah I** (1415 CE)
Gwalior Architecture	**Gujari Mahal**	Built by Raja **Man Singh Tomar** (1486–1516 CE); currently converted into a museum
Mewar Court Scholars	**Court of Rana Kumbha**	Scholars: **Muni Sunder Suri**, **Natha**, **Tilla Bhatt** (*Trap:* Muni Jin Vijay Suri was in Akbar's court, NOT Kumbha's)
Structural Typology	**Double Dome**	Sikandar Lodi Tomb / Humayun's Tomb
Structural Typology	**Octagonal Tomb**	Tomb of Sher Shah Suri (Sasaram)
Structural Typology	**True Arch Tomb**	Tomb of Balban (Delhi)
Structural Typology	**World's Largest Dome**	Gol Gumbad of Muhammad Adil Shah (Bijapur)

Common Traps — Don’t Fall For These

1. **Tin Darwaza–Ahmedabad is wrong.** Tin Darwaza is at **Bidar**, while Ahmedabad has **Teen Darwaza**.
2. **Lal Darwaza–Jaunpur is correct.** Do not mark this pair wrong in NOT-matched lists.
3. **Riyaz-us-Salatin is not Riyaz-ul-Insha.** The first is a history of **Bengal**; the second is **Gawan’s letters**.
4. **Kitab-i-Nauras is not Amuktamalyada.** Ibrahim Adil Shah II wrote the former; Krishnadevaraya wrote the latter.
5. **Krishnadevaraya was not the founder of Vijayanagara.Harihara I and Bukka I** founded the empire.
6. **Talikota is not Raichur.** Talikota (1565) was a defeat; Raichur (1520) was Krishnadevaraya’s victory.
7. **Rama Raya died at Talikota.** Krishnadevaraya had already died in **1529**.
8. **Mahmud Gawan was not the Bahmani founder.Hasan Gangu** founded the Bahmani Kingdom.
9. **Bijapur is not Bidar.** They are different Deccan centres, and **Gol Gumbaz** stands at Bijapur.
10. **Bahlul Lodi annexed Jaunpur in 1484**, not Sikandar Lodi.
11. **Gol Gumbaz is at Bijapur**, not at Hampi or Bidar.
12. The **nayankara system belongs to Vijayanagara**, not to the Bahmani taraf system.
13. **Jaunpur is in UP.** It is the only Topic-3 capital inside Uttar Pradesh.
14. There were **five Deccan Sultanates**, not Jaunpur, because the Sharqi state had already been annexed.
15. **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah** was the last Golkonda ruler when the Mughals captured it in **1687**.
16. **Jaunpur city** was founded by **Firuz** for **Jauna Khan (MbT)**; the **Sharqi state** was founded by **Malik Sarwar (Khwaja-i-Jahan)**. Last Sharqi = **Hussain Shah**.
17. **Siraj/Shiraz-i-Hind** = Jaunpur under **Ibrahim Shah**; education/culture explains the title.
18. **Yusuf Adil Shah ≠ Ahmadnagar**; **Jagatguru / Kitab-i-Nauras / Nauraspur** = **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** of Bijapur.
19. **Gol Gumbad** = **Muhammad Adil Shah** (Bijapur). **Bahadur Shah** of Gujarat gave **Diu** to the Portuguese.
20. **Malik Sarwar ≠ Malwa**. **Zain-ul-Abidin (Bud Shah)** abolished **jaziya** and banned **cow slaughter** in Kashmir.

Topic 4 — Bhakti & Sufi Movements

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Saguna	Nirguna	Formed deity (Krishna/Rama) vs formless one God (Kabir/Nanak)	सगुण / निर्गुण
Alvar	Nayanar	Vishnu devotees vs Shiva devotees (both south, early)	आल्वर / नायनार
Ramananda	Ramanuja	North Rama bhakti (Banaras) vs South philosopher (Vishishtadvaita)	रामानंद / रामानुज
Chishti	Suhrawardi	Reject wealth/state vs accept patronage and office	चिश्ती / सुहरावर्दी
Advaita	Vishishtadvaita	Shankara (world=maya) vs Ramanuja (soul distinct yet united)	अद्वैत / विशिष्टाद्वैत
Surdas	Tulsidas	Braj Krishna (Sursagar) vs Awadhi Rama (Ramcharitmanas)	सूरदास / तुलसीदास
Mirabai	Andal	Rajasthan Krishna devotee vs Tamil Alvar woman saint	मीराबाई / आंडाल
Basavanna	Ramanuja	Karnataka Lingayat reform (anti-caste, Ishtalinga) vs Tamil Vishishtadvaita philosopher	बसवन्ना / रामानुज
Jnaneshwar	Namdev	Varkari founder (Jnaneshwari Gita) vs earlier Vithoba saint in same line	ज्ञानेश्वर / नामदेव
Baba Farid	Kabir	Chishti saint (Ajodhan); verses in Adi Granth vs nirguna Kashi weaver-saint	बाबा फरीद / कबीर
Pir	Guru	Sufi spiritual master (silsilah) vs Bhakti preceptor	पीर / गुरु
Amarmul	Bijak	Kabir–Dharamdas dialogues vs main Kabirpanthi scripture	अमरमूल / बीजक
Prem Vatika	Rasik Priya	**Raskhan** vs **Keshavdas**	प्रेम वाटिका / रसिक प्रिया
Chisht (Afghanistan)	Ajmer	Order name origin vs Moinuddin's Indian centre	चिश्त / अजमेर
Ulema	Shaikh	Islamic law scholars vs Sufi guide authorised to teach	उलेमा / शेख
Firdausi	Chishti core	**Bihar** (Yahya Maneri line) vs Delhi–Ajmer Chishti belt	फिरदौसी / चिश्ती

4.1 Bhakti Movement — Origins

Why did Bhakti grow? (context)

Factor	How it mattered
Turkish conquests	Political uncertainty weakened old temple–court patronage networks in parts of the north.
Sanskrit monopoly	Ordinary people could not access Brahman-controlled Sanskrit ritual religion.
Vernacular need	Saints sang in **Tamil, Marathi, Hindi, Awadhi, Braj, Punjabi, Bengali** and reached peasants and artisans.
Sufi parallel	Chishti **sama**, equality, and love-of-God ideas created a shared moral atmosphere with Bhakti.
Social protest	Many sants challenged **jati (जाति) barriers**, costly pilgrimage, and priestly control over salvation.

Phase 1 — South India (7th–12th century)

Group	Deity	Number	Main text	Key fact
Nayanars (नायनार)	**Shiva**	**63** saints	**Tevaram** (तेवारम्) hymns	Shaiva Bhakti in Tamil Nadu
Alvars (आलवार)	**Vishnu**	**12** saints	**Divya Prabandham** (~**4000** hymns)	Called the **"Tamil Veda (वेद)"**

Phase 2 — Philosophical bridge (9th–12th century)

Thinker	School	One-line fact
Shankara	**Advaita** (अद्वैतवाद) (non-dualism)	World is **maya**; Brahman alone is real — intellectual backdrop, not mass Bhakti saint.
Ramanuja	**Vishishtadvaita** (विशिष्टद्वैतवाद) (qualified non-dualism)	God, soul, and world are related; **personal Vishnu bhakti** is the path.
Madhva	**Dvaita** (द्वैतवाद) (dualism)	Soul and God are eternally distinct.

Phase 3 — North Indian sant tradition (14th–17th century)

Stream	God idea	Representative saints	Key trait
Saguna	Personal God **with form** — Rama, Krishna, Vithoba	**Surdas**, **Tulsidas**, **Mirabai**, **Namdev**	Image, kirtan, emotional love-bhakti
Nirguna	**Formless** one God — Ram/Hari/Allah as names of the same absolute (निरपेक्ष)	**Kabir**, **Nanak**, **Ravidas**, **Dadu Dayal**	Rejected idol-centred ritual for many practices

What Bhakti saints rejected and accepted

Rejected	Accepted
Caste monopoly on worship and salvation	**Guru** (personal preceptor)
Sanskrit-only religion for the elite	**Vernacular** song (सोंग) and sermon
Empty **ritualism** without inner love	**Honest livelihood** (weaver, cobbler, farmer saints)
Costly **pilgrimage monopoly** (for many nirguna sants)	**Sangat** (संगत) / congregation bhajan
Brahman control as sole gate to moksha	**Women** and lower castes as devotees and poets

4.2 Major Bhakti Saints — Master Table

Saint	Region	Language	Tradition	Guru	Key work/trait
Namdev	Maharashtra	Marathi	Vithoba/Krishna	—	Earliest in north list; hymns in Adi Granth
Ramananda	Prayag–Banaras	Hindi	Rama saguna	Ramanuja line	Opened to all castes
Kabir	Kashi (काशी)	Hindi	Nirguna	**Ramananda**	Weaver; dohas; Ram=Allah; died **Maghar**
Ravidas	Varanasi (वाराणसी)	Hindi	Nirguna	**Ramananda**	Cobbler saint
Guru Nanak	Punjab	Punjabi	Nirguna/monotheism	Revelation	**Mardana** companion; 1469–1539
Chaitanya	Bengal	Bengali	Gaudiya Vaishnava	—	Sankirtan; 1486–1533
Surdas	Braj	Braj Bhasha	Krishna saguna	**Vallabhacharya**	Sursagar; blind poet
Tulsidas	Awadh (अवध)/UP	Awadhi	Rama saguna	—	**Ramcharitmanas** ~1574
Mirabai	Mewar (मेवाड़)	Rajasthani/Hindi	Krishna	—	Royal devotee
Dadu Dayal	Rajasthan	Hindi	Nirguna	—	Dadu Panth; Nipakhi path
Basavanna	Karnataka	Kannada	Virashaiva/Lingayat	—	Anubhava Mantapa; Vachanas; Ishtalinga
Jnaneshwar	Maharashtra	Marathi	Varkari/Vithoba	Nivruttinath	**Jnaneshwari** (ज्ञानेश्वरी) (Gita commentary)

Saint	Region	Language	Tradition	Guru	Key work/trait
Jayadeva	Odisha/Puri (पुरी)	Sanskrit	Krishna (Radha)	—	**Gita Govinda** (~12th c.)
Shankaradeva	Assam	Assamese	Eka (एका) Sarana Krishna	—	**Kirtana-ghosha**; satra centres

4.3 Chronology of Bhakti Saints

Order	Saint	Period
1	Alvars / Nayanars	7th–12th c.
1b	**Basavanna** / Lingayat	12th c.
1c	**Jayadeva** (Gita Govinda)	~12th c.
1d	**Jnaneshwar** (Varkari)	13th c.
2	**Namdev**	~1270–1350
3	Ramananda	14th–15th c.
4	**Kabir**	~1398–1518
5	**Guru Nanak**	1469–1539
6	**Chaitanya**	1486–1533
7	Mirabai	~1498–1547
8	Surdas	1478–1581
9	Tulsidas	1532–1623
10	Dadu Dayal	1544–1603

4.4 Guru–Shishya Tradition (★★★)

Disciple	Guru	Tradition
Kabir	**Ramananda**	Bhakti nirguna
Ravidas	**Ramananda**	Bhakti nirguna
Surdas	**Vallabhacharya**	Pushti Krishna bhakti
Mardana	**Guru Nanak**	Sikh founding companion
Amir Khusrau	**Nizamuddin Auliya**	Chishti Sufi
Amir Hasan Sijzi	Nizamuddin circle	Compiled Fawaid-ul-Fuad

4.9 Surdas, Tulsidas & Dadu Dayal

Saint	Dates	Tradition	Key work	Guru/link
Surdas	1478–1581	Krishna saguna (Braj)	**Sursagar**	**Vallabhacharya** (Pushti Marg / Shuddhadvaita)
Tulsidas	1532–1623	Rama saguna (Awadhi)	**Ramcharitmanas** (~1574)	—
Dadu Dayal	1544–1603	Nirguna (Rajasthan)	**Dadu Panth** hymns	— (Nipakhi non-sectarian)

4.10 Mirabai & Bhakti Women Poets

Poetess	Composition	Tradition	Period
Andal	Tiruppavai, Nachiyar Tirumozhi	Tamil Alvar (only woman Alvar)	~8th c.
Mirabai	Padas/bhajans to Krishna	Mewar/Rajasthan saguna	~1498–1547
Daya Bai	**Vinay Malika**, Dayabodh	Charandasi	18th c.
Sahajobai	**Sahaj Prakash**	Charandasi	18th c.
Son Kumari	**Poem of Swam Beli**	—	—

4.11 Vedanta Philosophy

Philosopher	School	Key idea
Shankaracharya (शंकर) (8th c.)	**Advaita**	Non-dual Brahman; world = maya
Ramanuja (11th–12th c.)	**Vishishtadvaita**	Qualified non-dualism; prapatti (surrender)
Madhvacharya (13th c.)	**Dvaita**	Dualism; God and soul distinct
Nimbarka (13th c.)	**Dvaitadvaita** (द्वैताद्वैतवाद)	Simultaneous unity and difference
Vallabhacharya (16th c.)	**Shuddhadvaita** (शुद्धाद्वैतवाद)	Pure non-dual Krishna bhakti; pushti marg

4.16 Suhrawardi, Qadiri & Naqshbandi Orders

Feature	Suhrawardi	Qadiri	Naqshbandi
State patronage	**Accepted**	Variable	Mughal (मुग़ल) court contact
Region	**Multan/Punjab**	Pan-India	Central Asia → north India
Key figure (India)	**Bahauddin Zakariya**	Abdul Qadir Jilani line	**Ahmad Sirhindi**
Syncretism	Moderate (नरम दल)	Moderate	**Opposed**
Music/sama	Less emphasis	Variable	**Opposed**

4.17 Regional Bhakti Traditions (NCERT / coaching map)

Maharashtra — Varkari sampradaya (Vithoba of Pandharpur)

Saint	Period	Key work / trait
Jnaneshwar (Jnanadeva)	13th c.	**Jnaneshwari** — Marathi commentary on the **Bhagavad Gita** in **ovi** metre
Namdev	~1270–1350	Early Varkari; **61 hymns** in Guru Granth Sahib; often cited as Islam-influenced among Maharashtra sants
Eknath	16th c.	Revived Varkari tradition; commentary on Jnaneshwari
Tukaram (तुकाराम)	17th c.	**Abhangas** to Vithoba; peak of Marathi popular Bhakti

4.18 Bhakti–Sufi Synthesis & Composite Culture

Bridge	What it shows
Guru Granth Sahib	Verses of **Kabir**, **Namdev**, **Ravidas**, and **Baba Farid** in one scripture

Bridge	What it shows
Kabir in Kashi	Lived in a city of **temples, mosques, and Chishti influence**; used Ram and Allah as names of one God
Nizamuddin circle	**Amir Khusrau's** qawwali and **yogic breathing** from Nath yogis
Chishti sama	Musical ecstasy paralleled **bhajan/kirtan** congregations
Dargah ziyarat	Hindu and Muslim pilgrims at **Ajmer** and **Delhi** shrines

How historians study Bhakti–Sufi (sources fact)

Source type	Examples	Use
Hagiography	*Bhaktamal*, saint biographies	Ideals of saints — often idealised
Hymn compilations	Tevaram, Divya Prabandham, Bijak, Adi Granth	Actual devotional language
Sufi malfuzat	**Fawaid-ul-Fuad** (Nizamuddin conversations)	Teachings of Chishti masters
Inscriptions & travellers	Dargah records, Ibn Battuta (इब्न बतूता) on khanqahs	Patronage and pilgrimage

4.9 Master Fact-Locks — Regional Saints, Sacred Geography & Medieval Literature

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Geographic / Cultural Lock
Guru Ghasidas (1756–1850)	Born Dec 1756 at **Giraudpuri** village (Balodabazar-Bhatapara dist, Chhattisgarh) to **Mahangu** and **Amarautin**. Founded the **Satnami movement** in Chhattisgarh opposing idolatry, caste hierarchy, and meat/liquor consumption.	Giraudpuri, Chhattisgarh
Namdev's Spiritual Lineage	Disciple of **Visoba Khechar**, who initiated him into mystical realization of the omnipresent, formless aspect of God. Tailor by caste; central pillar of **Varkari sampradaya**.	Narsi, Maharashtra / Pandharpur
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	Born 1486 at **Nadia (Navadvipa, Bengal)** in a Brahmin family; father **Jagannatha Mishra**, mother **Shachi Devi**. Childhood name was **Nimai** (Vishwambhar Mishra). Preached ecstatic Krishna-bhakti (Gaudiya Vaishnavism).	Nadia, West Bengal
Ajmer Dargah & Marathas	**Raja Sahu** (grandson of Chhatrapati Shivaji) was the **first Maratha Chieftain** to send and offer *nazr* (ceremonial offering) at the Dargah of Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti at Ajmer.	Ajmer, Rajasthan
Nizamuddin Auliya Titles	Adorned with titles **Mehboob-i-Elahi** ("Beloved of God") and **Sultan-ul-Mashaikh** ("King of Saints"). Called *Yogasiddha* for adept mastery of yogic breathing (pranayama).	Delhi (Ghiyaspur)
Medieval Romance / Mathnavi Literature	• **Chandayan** — composed by **Mulla Daud** (early Awadhi Sufi mathnavi, Lorik-Chanda tale) • **Padmavati Katha** — composed by **Damodar Kavi** • **Rag Vibodh** — composed by **Somnath** (musicology) • **Ashiqa** — composed by **Amir Khusrau** • **Premvatika** & **Sujan Raskhan** — composed by **Raskhan** (Sayyid Ibrahim) in pure Braj Bhasha	Persian & Regional Vernaculars
Christianity Exam Facts (Ghatnachakra)	• **Birthplace of Jesus Christ: Bethlehem** (near Jerusalem) • **Easter:** Celebrates the **Resurrection of Jesus Christ** on the third day after crucifixion • **Good Friday:** Commemorates the sacrificial crucifixion and death of Jesus Christ on Friday • **Saint Francis of Assisi (1181/82–1226):** Celebrated Christian patron saint revered for his extraordinary love for birds and animals.	Judea / Assisi (Italy)

4.10 The 12 Jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva (द्वादश ज्योतिर्लिंग)

No.	Jyotirlinga Shrine	State / Region	Associated River / Geographic Landmark
1	**Somnath**	Veraval, Saurashtra, Gujarat	Prabhas Patan, Arabian Sea coast

No.	Jyotirlinga Shrine	State / Region	Associated River / Geographic Landmark
2	**Nageshwar**	Near Dwarka, Gujarat	Char Dham circuit
3	**Mahakaleshwar**	Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh	Shipra River (only south-facing / Dakshinmukhi)
4	**Omkareshwar**	Khandwa / Mandhata, Madhya Pradesh	Island in Narmada River shaped like 'Om'
5	**Kedarnath**	Rudraprayag, Uttarakhand	Mandakini River, Garhwal Himalayas
6	**Kashi Vishwanath**	Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh	Holy Ganges River
7	**Baidyanath (Vaidyanath)**	Deoghar, Santhal Parganas, Jharkhand	Historic pilgrimage center
8	**Trimbakeshwar**	Nashik, Maharashtra	Source of the Godavari River
9	**Grishneshwar**	Verul (near Ellora Caves), Maharashtra	Near Daulatabad/Aurangabad
10	**Bhimashankar**	Sahyadri Hills (near Pune), Maharashtra	Source of Bhima River
11	**Mallikarjuna Swamy**	Srisailam, Andhra Pradesh	Nallamala Hills, Krishna River
12	**Rameshwaram (Ramanathaswamy)**	Rameswaram Island, Tamil Nadu	Pamban Island, Gulf of Mannar

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

1. Bhakti did **not** start with Kabir; the **Alvars and Nayanars** of south India in the **7th century** are the earliest phase.
2. **Kabir and Guru Nanak** were separate persons, and Kabir did not found Sikhism.
3. **Mardana** was Nanak's disciple, not his guru, so do not reverse the pair.
4. **Surdas** was a disciple of **Vallabhacharya**, not Ramananda.
5. **Tughlaqnama** is not by Ibn Battuta; that is a wrong topic bleed from another question.
6. **Nizamuddin** belongs to **Delhi**, never Multan.
7. **Fawaid-ul-Fuad** was compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi**, not Amir Khusrau.
8. **Ramcharitmanas** was written in **Awadhi**, not Sanskrit.
9. **Vallabhacharya** taught **Shuddhadvaita**, not Dvaita (Madhva taught Dvaita).
10. **Namdev** always comes before **Kabir** in chronology.
11. **Chaitanya** was a **saguna Krishna** devotee, not a nirguna saint.
12. **Chishti** saints rejected state wealth, while **Suhrawardi** saints accepted patronage.
13. **Gangabai — Ganesh Dev Leela** is the wrong poetess–composition pair.
14. **Tulsidas** (16th century) came **after** Kabir and Nanak, so do not place him earlier.
15. **Gorakhnath** belonged to the **Nathpanthi** tradition, not the Chishti order or mainstream Bhakti sants.
16. **Gita Govinda** (Jayadeva) is **not** the **Bhagavad Gita** — do not swap Radha–Krishna poetry with Krishna's battlefield sermon.
17. **Basavanna** belongs to **12th-century Karnataka Lingayat** reform — not north Indian Rama/Krishna sant line.
18. **Baba Farid** was **Chishti (Ajodhan)**, not Suhrawardi (Multan); his verses are in the **Adi Granth** alongside Kabir and Namdev.
19. **Jnaneshwari** is **Jnaneshwar's Marathi Gita commentary** — not Tulsidas's Awadhi Ramayana.
20. **Amarmul** = Kabir–Dharamdas dialogues; **Bijak** = Kabirpanthi scripture.
21. **Rasik Priya** = **Keshavdas**, not Raskhan (**Prem Vatika**).
22. Chishti order name = **Chisht (Afghanistan)**; Indian centre = **Ajmer** under Moinuddin (**Usman Haruni**'s disciple).
23. **Shaikh-ul-Hind** = **Salim Chishti**; **Mehboob-i-Ilahi** = **Nizamuddin**; **Chirag-i-Delhi** = **Nasiruddin**.
24. **Naqshbandi** opposed **Sama**; **Firdausi** centres on **Bihar**; **Ulema** ≠ Sufi term.
25. **Tulsidas** = Rajapur (**Chitrakoot**), wife **Ratnawali**, contemporaries **Akbar–Jahangir**.
26. **Shankaradeva** = Assam/Kamarupa Vaishnavism; **Malukdas** = **Kada** (Kaushambi).

Topic 5 — Medieval Literature

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Akbarnama	Ain-i-Akbari	Narrative history of Akbar vs admin/statistical gazetteer — both Abul Fazl	अकबरनामा / आइन-ए-अकबरी
Baburnama	Akbarnama	Babur's Turki memoir vs Abul Fazl's Persian Akbar history	बाबरनामा / अकबरनामा
Tarikh	Tabaqat	Annal/continuous history vs generational biographies ("classes")	तारीख / तबक़ात
Barani	Ibn Battuta	Delhi Sultanate historian vs Moroccan traveller (Rihla)	बरनी / इब्न बतूता
Tughlaqnama	Rihla	Amir Khusrau's historical masnavi on Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq vs Ibn Battuta's travelogue	तुग़लक़नामा (अमीर खुसरो) / रिहला (इब्न बतूता)
Barani	Afif (Tarikh)	Barani's Tarikh (Balban→early Firuz) vs Afif's later Tarikh (Firuz→end)	बरनी / आफ़िफ़
Padmavat	Padmavati Katha	Jaisi's Awadhi epic vs Damodar Kavi's **Padmavati Katha**	पद्मावत / पद्मावती कथा
Riyaz-us-Salatin	Riyaz-ul-Insha	Bengal history vs Gawan's official letters	रियाज़-उस-सलातीन / रियाज़-उल-इंशा
Amir Khusrau	Tansen	13th–14th c. Sultanate poet vs Akbar's dhrupad master	अमीर खुसरो / तानसेन
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Padshahnama	Emperor's own memoir vs court historian's Shah Jahan chronicle	तुज़ुक / पादशाहनामा
Ashiqa	Rag Vibodh	Amir Khusrau's romantic historical poem (Deval Rani) vs Somnath's Sanskrit music treatise (1609)	आशिक़ा (खुसरो) / राग विबोध (सोमनाथ)
Persian	Turki (Mughal)	Mughal court language vs Babur's mother-tongue memoir only	फ़ारसी / चग़ताई तुर्की

5.2 Medieval Books and Their Authors — Master Table

Book	Author	Period	Language	Type
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani	Sultanate	Persian	Tabaqat chronicle
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	Ziauddin Barani	Sultanate	Persian	Tarikh (Balban (बलबन)→Firuz)
Tughlaqnama	Ziauddin Barani	Sultanate	Persian	Tughlaq history
Fatawa-i-Jahandari	Ziauddin Barani	Sultanate	Persian	Political theory of kingship
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi (later)	Shams-i-Siraj **Afif**	Sultanate	Persian	Firuz Shah → end of Sultanate
Taj-ul-Maasir	Hasan Nizami	Sultanate	Persian	Early Delhi conquests
Khazain-ul-Futuh	Amir Khusrau	Sultanate	Persian	Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) conquests
Miftah-ul-Futuh	Amir Khusrau	Sultanate	Persian	Jalaluddin Khalji victories
Rag Vibodh	Somnath	Sultanate–early Mughal	Sanskrit	Music treatise (1609)
Khamsa	Amir Khusrau	Sultanate	Persian	Five masnavis
Kitab-ul-Hind	**Alberuni**	Ghaznavid (ग़ज़नवी)	Arabic	India under Mahmud/Ghazni
Rihla	Ibn Battuta	Sultanate	Arabic	Travelogue
Baburnama (Tuzk-e-Babri)	Babur	Mughal	**Chagatai Turki**	Memoir

Book	Author	Period	Language	Type
Humayunnama	Gulbadan Begum	Mughal	Persian	Biography
Akbarnama	Abul Fazl	Mughal	Persian	Official narrative history
Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl	Mughal	Persian	Admin gazetteer
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir	Mughal	Persian	Emperor's memoir
Padshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori	Mughal	Persian	Shah Jahan chronicle
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Abdul Qadir Badauni	Mughal	Persian	Critical history
Alamgirnama	Mirza Muhammad Kazim	Mughal	Persian	Aurangzeb reign chronicle

Vernacular works:

Work	Author	Language
Chandayan	Mulla Daud	Awadhi/Hindavi
Padmavati Katha	Damodar Kavi	—
Ashiqa	Amir Khusrau	—
Padmavat	**Malik Muhammad Jaisi**	Awadhi/Hindavi
Rag Vibodh	Somnath	Sanskrit

Regional Persian chronicles:

Book	Author (fact)	Region / subject
Mirat-e-Sikandari	Sikandar ibn Muhammad (**Manjhu**)	**Gujarat** Sultanate history
Burhan-e-Masir	Sayyid (सैयद) Ali **Tabatabai**	**Bahmani** and **Ahmadnagar** (Nizam (निजाम) Shahi)
Riyaz-us-Salatin	Ghulam Husain **Salim**	**Bengal** Muslim rule
Riyaz-ul-Insha	Letters of **Mahmud Gawan**	Bahmani wazir (वज़ीर)'s state correspondence

Translation works:

Work	Translator/Author	Notes
Tutinama	Khwaja Ziya-ud-din **Nakhshabi**	Persian translation of *Suka Saptati* — **not** Amir Khusrau
Razmnama	Faizi/Naqib Khan team	Persian Mahabharata under Akbar
Ramayana (Persian)	Abdul Qadir Badauni team	Akbar's kitabkhana (किताबखाना) translation
Atharva Veda (Persian)	Akbar's translators	Part of imperial translation project
Baburnama (Persian)	Abdur Rahim (रहीम) Khan-i-Khanan	Translated Babur's Turki memoir
Rajatarangini (राजतरंगिणी) (Persian)	Ziauddin **Nakhshabi**	Early Sultanate Sanskrit→Persian translation

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5.7 Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi & Tabaqat-i-Nasiri

Feature	Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi
Author	Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani	Ziauddin Barani
Period	Ghurid (गौर) → ~1260	Balban → Firuz Shah
Format	Tabaqat (generational classes)	Tarikh (annals)
Patron	Nasiruddin Mahmud	Firuz Shah Tughlaq

Barani vs Afif — two Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi

Author	Work	Coverage
Ziauddin Barani	**Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**	**Balban** (बलबन) → early **Firuz Shah Tughlaq**
Shams-i-Siraj Afif	**Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**	**Firuz Shah** → **end of Delhi Sultanate**

5.9 Akbarnama & Ain-i-Akbari (Abul Fazl)

	Akbarnama	Ain-i-Akbari
Type	Narrative history (3 volumes)	Administrative gazetteer
Focus	Akbar's life, campaigns, policies	Revenue, army (सेना), provinces, society data
Trap	Called "gazetteer" = wrong	Called "biography" = wrong

5.13 Supplementary Works — Alberuni, Jaisi, Badauni, Isami

Quick learn table (read this first)

Who	Book	Language	One-line fact
Alberuni	**Kitab-ul-Hind**	Arabic	India under **Mahmud of Ghazni** — science, religion, society
Malik Muhammad Jaisi	**Padmavat**	Awadhi	Sufi romance of **Padmini / Ratan Sen** (~16th c.)
Mulla Daud	**Chandayan**	Awadhi/Hindavi	Early vernacular love romance (same stream as Jaisi)
Abdul Qadir Badauni	**Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh**	Persian	Secret **anti-Akbar** history written at court
Abdul Malik Isami	**Futuh-us-Salatin**	Persian	**Bahmani / Deccan** history
Mirza Muhammad Kazim	**Alamgirnama**	Persian	**Aurangzeb** reign chronicle
Firuz Shah Tughlaq	**Fatwa-i-Firuz Shahi**	Persian	Sultan's own rules — **not** Barani's Fatawa-i-Jahandari

5.13.2 Vernacular Awadhi line (UP angle)

Book	Author	Remember
Padmavat	**Malik Muhammad Jaisi**	Awadhi epic; UP fact
Padmavati Katha	**Damodar Kavi**	Appears in vernacular book–author match lists

5.13.3 Badauni — critical counter-history

Historian	Attitude	Main works
Abdul Qadir Badauni	**Hostile** / critical	**Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh**
Abul Fazl	**Official** / panegyric	**Akbarnama**, **Ain-i-Akbari**

5.13.4 Other coaching-map facts

Book	Author	Fact
Futuh-us-Salatin	**Abdul Malik Isami**	Bahmani / Deccan history
Alamgirnama	Mirza Muhammad Kazim	**Aurangzeb** reign chronicle
Fatwa-i-Firuz Shahi	**Firuz Shah Tughlaq**	Sultan's own regulations — not Barani's **Fatawa-i-Jahandari**

Common Traps — Don’t Fall For These

1. **Tughlaqnama** was **not** written by Ibn Battuta; the correct author is **Barani**.
2. **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** was **not** written by Shams-i-Siraj Alif; the correct author is **Barani**.
3. **Baburnama** was originally written in **Chagatai Turki**, not Persian.
4. **Turki** was **not** the Mughal court language; **Persian** was the court language.
5. **Ain-i-Akbari** is **not** a biography; **Akbarnama** is narrative history, while Ain-i-Akbari is an **administrative gazetteer**.
6. **Akbarnama** was **not** written by Jahangir; **Abul Fazl** wrote it under Akbar.
7. **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** was **not** written by Abul Fazl; **Jahangir** wrote his own memoir.
8. **Padshahnama** is **not** about Akbar or Jahangir; it chronicles **Shah Jahan** (Abdul Hamid Lahori).
9. **Rag Vibodh** belongs to **Somnath** (1609); **Ashiqa** belongs to **Amir Khusrau** — never swap them.
10. **Amir Khusrau** did **not** serve Akbar or Tansen’s court; he was a 13th–14th century Sultanate poet.
11. **Ibn Battuta** was an eyewitness **traveller** who wrote **Rihla**, not a Tughlaq historian.
12. **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** was **not** written by Barani; the correct author is **Minhaj-us-Siraj**.
13. **Tutinama** was **not** translated by Amir Khusrau; the translator was **Nakhshabi**.
14. Abul Fazl family death order is **Faizi (1595) → Sheikh Mubarak (1597) → Abul Fazl (1602) → Daniyal (1604)**, not 2-1-4-3.
15. **Riyaz-us-Salatin** is Bengal history, while **Riyaz-ul-Insha** contains Gawan’s letters; do not swap them.
16. **Khazain-ul-Futuh** (Alauddin) and **Miftah-ul-Futuh** (Jalaluddin) are both **Amir Khusrau** works — not Barani.
17. **Fatawa-i-Jahandari** is Barani’s **political theory** — not the same as **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** narrative history.
18. **Padmavat** (Jaisi) ≠ **Padmavati Katha** (Damodar Kavi) — different authors in vernacular match traps.
19. **Kitab-ul-Hind** = **Alberuni** (Arabic, Ghaznavid era) — not a Delhi Sultanate court chronicle.
20. **Shams-i-Siraj Afif** also wrote a **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**, but the standard chronicle pair is **Barani**, not Afif.

Topic 7 — Mughal Empire

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Panipat I	II vs III	1526 Babur–Ibrahim; 1556 Akbar–Hemu; 1761 Marathas–Abdali	पानीपत I / II / III
Chausa	Kannauj	1539 Humayun escaped; 1540 decisive Sher Shah win	चौसा / कन्नौज
Daurah	Dharmat	**1532** Humayun vs Afghans; **Apr 1658** Aurangzeb vs Jaswant Singh	दौराह / धर्मत
Dharmat	Samugarh	Apr 1658 Jaswant Singh; May 1658 Dara defeated	धर्मत / समुगढ़
Zabt	Dahsala	Measurement-based assessment vs 10-year average yield	ज़ब्त / दहसाला
Zat	Sawar	Personal rank vs cavalry obligation	ज़ात / सवार
Jagir	Khalsa	Assigned to mansabdars vs crown land	जागीर / खालसा
Sulh-i-Kul	Din-i-Ilahi	Universal peace policy vs 1582 small court cult	सुलह-ए-कुल / दीन-ए-इलाही
Akbarnama	Ain-i-Akbari	Narrative history vs admin gazetteer — both Abul Fazl	अकबरनामा / आइन-ए-अकबरी
Buland Darwaza	Panch Mahal	Gujarat victory gate vs five-storey palace at Sikri	बुलंद दरवाज़ा / पंच महल
Padshah at Kabul	after Panipat	**1504 Kabul** title vs **27 April 1526** Indian empire proclamation	काबुल पादशाह / पानीपत
Chagatai	Timurid claim	Ethnic **Chagatai Turk** line vs **Timur** descent for legitimacy	चगताई / तैमूर
Alam Khan	Daulat Khan	Ibrahim's **uncle**/pretender vs Punjab governor invite	आलम खान / दौलत खान
Bairam Khan	Rahim	Regent; **Khan-i-Khana from Akbar** vs son, Hindi poet	बैरम खान / रहीम
Dara	Aurangzeb	Scholar, syncretic; orthodox, won 1658	दारा / औरंगज़ेब
Balkh failure	Deccan annexation	Shah Jahan's **1646–47** prestige flop vs Aurangzeb's **Bijapur 1686 / Golkonda 1687**	बल्ख / दक्कन
Bahadur Shah I	Zafar	**1707** successor of Aurangzeb vs **last** Mughal **1837–57**	बहादुर शाह I / ज़फ़र
Rangeela	Farrukhsiyar	**Nadir / Peacock Throne 1739** vs **1717** Company farman + Sayyid peak	रंगीला / फ़र्रुख़

7.2 Major Battles — Master Chronology

Mughal Schools of Painting — Teaching Card

Year	Battle	Winner vs loser	Fact
1526	Panipat I	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	Empire founded
1527	Khanwa	Babur vs Rana Sanga	Rajput confederacy broken
1528	Chanderi	Babur vs Medini Rai	Malwa pocket
1529	Ghagra	Babur vs Afghans	Eastern Afghans
1532	**Daurah**	Humayun vs Afghan chiefs (Bihar)	**Before** Chausa
1539	Chausa	Sher Shah vs Humayun	Humayun escaped Ganga (गंगा)
1540	Kannauj / **Bilgram**	Sher Shah vs Humayun	Exile begins
1556	Panipat II	Akbar/Bairam vs **Hemu**	Mughal restoration
1572	**Sarnal**	Akbar (Gujarat)	Akbar's Gujarat victory

Year	Battle	Winner vs loser	Fact
1658 Apr	**Dharmat**	Aurangzeb vs Jaswant Singh	Near Ujjain (उज्जैन)
1658 May	**Samugarh**	Aurangzeb vs Dara	Near Agra
1659	**Deorai**	Aurangzeb vs Dara	Ajmer (अजमेर)
1707	**Jajau**	Bahadur Shah I vs Azam Shah	After Aurangzeb

7.9 Akbar's Court Personalities

Person	Role
Bairam Khan	Regent; **Khan-i-Khana from Akbar** — only statement 1 true; statement 2 false
Abul Fazl	*Akbarnama* + *Ain-i-Akbari*; murdered **1602** (Bir Singh Bundela / Salim)
Faizi	Brother; poet laureate; died **1595**
Sheikh Mubarak	Father of Faizi/Abul Fazl; died **1593**
Todar Mal	Zabt + dahsala
Birbal	Witty Navratna; killed **1586** Yusufzai (NW) campaign
Raja Man Singh (राजा मान सिंह)	Amber; Haldighati; Bengal/Bihar commands
Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana	Bairam's son; Hindi dohas; translated Baburnama
Tansen (तानसेन)	Dhrupad (ध्रुपद) Navratna; earlier **Bhata/Rewa** (Topic 6)
Daniyal	Akbar's son; died **1605**

7.13 Tombs and royal families

Emperor	Tomb city
Babur	**Kabul**
Humayun	**Delhi**
Akbar	**Sikandra** (Agra belt)
Jahangir	**Lahore**
Shah Jahan	**Agra** (Taj)
Aurangzeb	**Khuldabad** (simple grave)
Rabia Daurani	**Bibi ka Maqbara**, Aurangabad

7.14 Later Mughals (1707–1857)

Quick chronology traps

Trap	Correct
Bahadur Shah I = Bahadur Shah Zafar (बहादुर शाह ज़फ़र)	**I** succeeds Aurangzeb (**1707**); **Zafar** is last (**1837–57**)
Nadir Shah under Aurangzeb	**Muhammad Shah Rangeela**, **Karnal/Delhi 1739**
Peacock Throne last used by Shah Jahan only	Last sitting (बैठक) emperor on it = **Muhammad Shah**
Sayyid Brothers under Rangeela's whole reign	Peak kingmaking **Farrukhsiyar** era; broken under **Muhammad Shah**

7.13 Master Fact-Locks — Babur & Akbar (Ghatnachakra Complete Alignment)

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Historic Context
Babur's Lineage & Invasions	• Chagatai Turk lineage (named after Genghis Khan's 2nd son). • Defeated at **Battle of Sar-e-Pul** (1501 CE) by **Shaybani Khan** using Uzbek *Tulughma* tactics. • Assumed royal title **Padshah** at Kabul (1504 CE), discarding ancestral title *Mirza*. • Invited to invade India by **Alam Khan** (uncle of Ibrahim Lodi), **Daulat Khan** (governor of Punjab, via son Dilawar Khan), and **Rana Sanga** of Mewar. • First Battle of Panipat (21 April 1526): artillery commanded by **Ustad Ali Quli**, gunners by **Mustafa**. Earned title **Qalandar** for largesse. • Declared **Jihad** at Battle of Khanwa (1527), assumed title **Ghazi**. • Defeated Medini Rai at Chanderi (1528); defeated Mahmud Lodi at Ghaghra (1529). • **Literary:** Composed *Tuzuk-i-Babri* in Turkish (mentions **Vijayanagara** and **Mewar**); authored *Mubaiyan* (Muslim law in verse) and invented *Khat-i-Baburi* (*Risal-i-Usaj*). • **Babri Mosque:** Built at Ayodhya by commander **Mir Baqi**.	Foundation of Mughal Rule
Akbar's Coronation & Matrimony	• Born 15 Oct 1542 at Amarkot in **Raja Veersaal's Palace** to Hamida Banu Begum. • Coronated at **Kalanaur** (Gurdaspur, Punjab) on 14 Feb 1556 at age 13; **Shah Abdul Mali** refused to attend. • Guardian **Bairam Khan** served as *Wazir* with title **Khan-i-Khanan**. • First Rajput matrimonial alliance: with **Kachhwaha** Rajputs of Amber; Raja **Bihari Mal (Bharmal)** submitted at Sanganer and gave daughter **Harkhabai** (mother of Jahangir) in marriage (1562 CE). • Executed foster-brother **Adham Khan** in 1562 for assassinating Prime Minister **Atgah Khan**.	Early Reign & Alliances
Unconquered Rajput Heroes	• **Rao Chandrasen of Marwar:** Fought at Bhadrajun (1565), Siwana, and Sojat (1579); retreated to hills and died in 1581 without surrendering to Akbar ("*The Forgotten Hero / Pratap of Marwar*"). • **Rani Durgavati of Gondwana:** Fought Mughal forces under Asaf Khan (1564) on behalf of minor son Vir Narayan; died defending Garh-Mandla.	Resistance to Imperial Expansion
Haldighati Details (1576 CE)	• Deputed **Raja Man Singh** (with Asaf Khan) leading ~5,000 Mughal troops to subdue Maharana Pratap. • Afghan commander leading Maharana Pratap's vanguard was **Hakim Khan Sur** (descendant of Sher Shah Suri).	Battle of Haldighati
Abul Fazl's Assassination	In 1602 CE, Prince Salim (Jahangir), while in rebellion at Allahabad, conspired with **Vir Singh Deo Bundela**, who assassinated Abul Fazl while returning from the Deccan.	Late Akbari court intrigues
Administration & Revenue	• **Mir Bakshi:** Head of imperial military department; oversaw recruitment, rolls (*chehra*), horse branding (*dagh*), and salary sanction; **NOT** the commander-in-chief. • **Mansabdari System:** Introduced in 19th regnal year (1574–75 CE), borrowed from Mongolian decimal military division (Genghis Khan). Three classes: Mansabdar (10–499), Amir (500–2499), Amir-i-Azam (2500+). 10 horsemen maintained 20 horses (*du-aspa* replacement rule). • **Ain-i-Dahsala (1580 CE / 24th regnal year):** Todarmal Bandobast; calculated 10-year average yield and prices; 1/3 fixed as state share (*maal*). Formulated by **Raja Todarmal**, **Khwaja Shah Mansoor**, and **Muzaffar Khan Turbati** (who first achieved proper status of imperial Diwan).	Civil & Military Framework
Social & Religious Reforms	• Abolished slavery (1562), pilgrimage tax (1563), and Jizya (1564). • Prohibited forced Sati and child marriage; fixed minimum marriage ages at **14 for girls** and **16 for boys**; allowed girls to marry by choice without parental coercion; enforced monogamy unless first wife was barren. • **Ibadat Khana (1575 CE):** Opened to all religious traditions in 1578 CE. • **Mahzarnama (1579 CE):** Infallibility decree prepared by **Shaikh Mubarak**; declared Akbar *Sultan-i-Adil / Imam-i-Adil*. • **Fatwa from Jaunpur (1580 CE):** Issued by Mulla Muhammad Yazdi against Akbar. • **Din-i-Ilahi (1582 CE):** Syncretic ideology based on Sufi pantheism and *Sulh-i-Kul* (universal peace); Abul Fazl was chief priest; only **Birbal** among Hindus accepted; Mohsin Fani described it in *Dabistan-i-Mazahib*.	Religious Policy & Syncretism

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Historic Context
Jain Scholars in Akbar's Court	• **Hari Vijay Suri:** Conferred the title **Jagadguru** by Akbar; persuaded Akbar to embrace vegetarianism and ban animal slaughter. • **Jin Chandra Suri:** Conferred the title **Yug Pradhan** by Akbar.	Jain-Mughal dialogue
Arts, Literature & Architecture	• **Zari Qalam ("Golden Pen"):** Imperial title conferred upon Kashmiri calligrapher **Muhammad Husain**. • **Translation Department:** Headed by **Faizi**; *Mahabharata* translated into Persian as ***Razmnama*** by Faizi, Badauni, Naqib Khan; *Ramayana* by Badauni; *Leelavati* by Faizi; *Kaliyadaman* by Abul Fazl. • **Painters:** Daswant (son of potter, painted *Razmnama*, committed suicide), Basawan, Keshav Lal, Mukund. • **Discovery of America:** Explicitly recorded by **Abul Fazl** in *Ain-i-Akbari*. • **Panch Mahal:** 5-storey pyramid palace in Fatehpur Sikri based on Buddhist monastery design (84 ground pillars). • **Turkish Sultana's Palace:** Praised as *"Pearl of Architecture"* by Percy Brown. • **Akbar's Tomb (Sikandra):** 5-storey mammoth monument with domeless square apex, planned by Akbar, completed 1613 CE by Jahangir.	Akbari Renaissance
Foreign Relations & Europeans	• Contemporary of **Queen Elizabeth I** of England (1558–1603 CE; English East India Company founded 1600 CE under Akbar's reign). • First English traveler: **Ralph Fitch** (1583–1586 CE), visited Agra and Fatehpur Sikri. • Jesuit Missions from Goa: 1st (1580, Sikri), 2nd (1591, Lahore), 3rd (1595, Lahore) led by **Jerome Xavier** and including Father **Antonio Monserrate** (tutor to Prince Murad).	Global Connections
Bengal & Bihar Annexation (1576 CE)	Daud Khan Karrani invaded Patna fort; Munim Khan took Bihar in 1574; Todarmal decisively defeated and executed Daud Khan on 12 July 1576, permanently integrating Bengal and Bihar into the Mughal Empire.	Territorial Consolidation

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

1. **Baburnama** was written in **Chagatai Turki**, but the Mughal **court language** was **Persian**.
2. **Buland Darwaza** commemorates Akbar's **Gujarat victory of 1572**, not Jahangir's birth.
3. **Daurah (1532)** is Humayun's early victory; **Dharmat (1658)** is Aurangzeb's succession battle. Do not swap them.
4. When Kannauj, Daurah, Samugarh, and Chausa appear together, chronological order is **Daurah (1532)** → **Chausa (1539)** → **Kannauj (1540)** → **Samugarh (1658)**.
5. **Akbar** gave **Bairam Khan** the title **Khan-i-Khanan** — only statement 1 is true; statement 2 is false.
6. **Mansab** was **not hereditary** under Akbar.
7. **Ain-i-Akbari** is an administrative gazetteer; **Akbarnama** is narrative biography.
8. **William Hawkins** reached India in **1608**, not 1611.
9. **Hamida Banu Begum** was **Humayun's** wife, not Alauddin Khalji's.
10. When Aurangzeb captured **Golkonda in 1687**, the last ruler was **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah**, not an Adil Shahi sultan.
11. **Nahr-i-Bihisht** in Shahjahanabad used water from the restored **Firuz Rajabwah**; it was not a wholly new Akbar-era canal.
12. **Kavindra Acharya Saraswati** of Banaras was patronised by **Shah Jahan**, not Akbar.
13. **Jajau (1707)** came after Aurangzeb's death; it is not one of the 1658 succession battles.
14. **Bahadur Shah I (1707)** is not **Bahadur Shah Zafar (1837–57)** — first after Aurangzeb versus last Mughal.
15. **Nadir Shah's 1739** sack hit **Muhammad Shah Rangeela**, not Aurangzeb or Shah Alam II.
16. **Din-i-Ilahi (1582)** was a small court circle, not a mass religion.
17. In the Mughal military-state A/R, the empire began as a military state and central vitality rested on army power — Reason explains Assertion.
18. The **Ilahi calendar (1584)** is separate from **Din-i-Ilahi (1582)**.

19. The **Hamzanama** folio cycle belongs to **Akbar's** atelier, not Jahangir's natural-history albums with Mansur.
20. **Chagatai Turks** — not Ottoman or Seljuk — were Babur's lineage; **Padshah** came at **Kabul (1504)**, Indian empire after **Panipat (27 April 1526)**.
21. **Alam Khan** was Ibrahim Lodi's **uncle**, not the same as **Daulat Khan Lodi** of Punjab.
22. **Mir Baqi** (Babur's commandant) built the **Babri Masjid** — state as a single careful fact.
23. Court death order: **Mubarak 1593 → Faizi 1595 → Abul Fazl 1602 → Daniyal 1605**.
24. Shah Jahan's **Balkh (1646–47)** failed; do not confuse it with Aurangzeb's successful **Bijapur / Golkonda** annexations.

Topic 8 — Sher Shah Suri

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Farid Khan	Sher Shah	Birth name vs Padshah title after 1540	फरीद खान / शेर शाह
Sher Khan	Sher Shah	Tiger-kill title in Bihar vs imperial title	शेर खान / शेर शाह
Chausa	Kannauj	1539 escape vs 1540 exile	चौसा / कन्नौज
Bilgram	Kannauj	Same 1540 battle	बिलग्राम / कन्नौज
Daurah	Chausa	1532 Humayun–Afghans vs 1539 Sher Shah	दौराह / चौसा
Jarib	Rai	Measuring rope vs crop-rate per bigha	जरीब / रै
Patta	Qabuliat	State document vs peasant acceptance	पट्टा / क़बूलियत
Dam	Rupiya vs Mohur	Copper vs silver vs gold	दाम / रुपया / मोहर
Shiqdar	Munshif	Law/order vs accounts	शिकदार / मुंशिफ
Rohtas	Purana Qila	Bihar hill fort vs Delhi citadel	रोहतास / पुराना किला
Sasaram	Kalinjar	Birth + tomb vs death siege 1545	सासाराम / कालिंजर
Hazrat-e-Ala	Sher Shah	Bengal-service title vs imperial **Sher Shah** after **Chausa 1539**	हज़रत-ए-आला / शेर शाह
Jaunpur education	Sasaram birth	**Siraj-i-Hind** schooling vs birthplace/tomb	जौनपुर / सासाराम
Marwar	Mewar (Jayata–Kumpa)	Rathore Maldeo vs Sisodia Pratap/Sanga	मारवाड़ / मेवाड़

8.6 Military Reforms

8.6 Master Fact-Locks — Humayun, Sur Administration & Mughal Architecture

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Historic Significance
Babur's Sons & Mothers	• **Humayun:** Eldest son, born 1508 in Kabul to **Maham Begum** (Shia lineage). • **Kamran & Askari:** Born to **Gulrukh Begum**. • **Hindal:** Born to **Dildar Begum**. • *Rao Jaitsi of Bikaner:* Kamran Mirza was defeated in the 1530s by **Rao Jaitsi** of Bikaner, celebrated in Beethu Souza's text *Rao-Jaitsi-Ro-Chhanda*.	Mughal dynastic origins
Humayun's Early Campaigns	• **Kalinjar Campaign (1531 CE)** • **First Siege of Chunar (1532 CE):** Humayun besieged Chunar Fort for 4 months until Sher Khan submitted. • **Raisina Fort (1532 CE):** Annexed by Humayun. • *Sur Negotiation:* Sher Khan offered to surrender Bihar and pay an annual tribute of 10 lakh dinars if allowed to retain Bengal; Humayun rejected the offer.	Early Mughal-Afghan rivalry
Bengal Administrative Restructuring	To prevent provincial insurrections, Sher Shah restructured Bengal into **19 Sirkars** (districts) under military Shiqdars, superintended by a civilian head titled **Amir-i-Bengal** (or *Amin-i-Bengal*). The renowned scholar **Qazi Fajilat** was the first appointed to this office. Across the rest of the empire, he instituted 47 Sirkars.	Administrative decentralization
Military Units of Islam Shah Suri	Sher Shah's successor **Islam Shah Suri** (ruled 1545–1553 CE) divided his imperial troops into standardized decimal-like units of **200, 250, and 500** soldiers, a structure later preserved by Sikandar Shah Suri.	Sur military reforms

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Historic Significance
Humayun's Tomb Architecture	Built at Delhi (1565–1572 CE) under the patronage of Humayun's senior widow **Haji Begum** (Bega Begum). Designed by the Persian architect **Mirak Mirza Ghiyas**. First mature **double-dome mausoleum** of Mughal architecture, set within a grand Persian Charbagh layout.	Precursor to the Taj Mahal

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

1. **Jarib** is a **measuring rope**, not a tax.
2. **Jayata and Kumpa** impressed Sher Shah in **Marwar** under Rao Maldeo, not in Mewar.
3. **Chausa (1539)** is where Humayun escaped on a water-skin; **Kannauj/Bilgram (1540)** sent him into exile. Do not swap them.
4. **Daurah (1532)** is Humayun's battle; it is neither **Dharmat (1658)** nor **Chausa (1539)**.
5. When Kannauj, Daurah, Samugarh, and Chausa appear together, order is **Daurah (1532)** → **Chausa (1539)** → **Kannauj (1540)** → **Samugarh (1658)**.
6. **Sasaram** holds Sher Shah's tomb; **Kalinjar** is where he died in 1545.
7. **Sher Khan** was his earlier title; he took **Sher Shah** and the style of Padshah after 1540.
8. **Islam Shah** ruled after Sher Shah; **Humayun** returned in **1555**, not Islam Shah.
9. **Khayr-ul-Manazil** mosque was built by **Maham Anaga** in Akbar's time; **Purana Qila** is Sher Shah's Delhi fort.
10. The **Grand Trunk Road** ran from **Sonargaon to Peshawar**, not only from Agra to Lahore.
11. The **Shiqdar** handled policing; the **Munshif** kept accounts. They are different officers.
12. **Bilgram (Kannauj, 1540)** is the same decisive Humayun defeat; it is not a separate later war name.
13. Akbar continued Sher Shah's **Dam** as the chief copper coin.
14. Sher Shah ruled only about **five years (1540–1545)**, but his reforms became the template for Akbar.
15. **Khanwa (1527)** was Babur's battle against Rana Sanga, not Sher Shah's war.
16. **Farid Khan** was educated at **Jaunpur (Siraj-i-Hind)**, not only born at Sasaram.
17. **Hazrat-e-Ala** was an earlier title; **Sher Shah** followed **Chausa (1539)**, not Daurah (1532).
18. **Qila-i-Kuhna** is **inside Purana Qila** — do not confuse with **Khayr-ul-Manazil** (Maham Anaga).
19. **RO 2021** — Sher Shah's **qualities as ruler** (stmt 1) outlasted battlefield fame; he **did** leave admin legacy (stmt 2 false).

Topic 9 — Rajputs

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Khanwa	Haldighati	1527 Babur–Sanga vs 1576 Man Singh–Pratap	खानवा / हल्दीघाटी
Mewar	Marwar	Sisodia Chittor–Udaipur vs Rathore Jodhpur	मेवाड़ / मारवाड़
Rana Chunda	Rao Chunda	Mewar vs Marwar founder line — 2021 trap	राणा चुंडा / राव चुंडा
Sanga	Pratap	Fought Babur vs fought Akbar	सांगा / प्रताप
Man Singh	Pratap	Kachhwaha on Mughal side vs Sisodia holdout	मान सिंह / प्रताप
Chittor	Udaipur	Old fort (1303, 1568) vs new capital 1559	चित्तौड़ / उदयपुर
Jauhar	Saka	Women's immolation vs warriors' last charge	जौहर / साका
Hamir	Kumbha	14th c. restorer vs 15th c. Vijay Stambha builder	हमीर / कुम्भा
Rana Hammir	Hamir Deva	Mewar restorer (1326) vs Ranthambore Chauhan (died 1301)	मेवाड़ हमीर / रणथम्भौर हमीर
Vijay Stambha	Kirti Stambha	Kumbha's victory tower vs older Jain tower, both at Chittor	विजय स्तम्भ / कीर्ति स्तम्भ
Alauddin's Chittor	Akbar's	1303 vs 1567–68	अलाउद्दीन / अकबर

9.2 Rajput States — Ruler Match

State	Clan	Capital
Mewar	Sisodia (older **Guhila**)	Chittor → **Udaipur (1559)**
Marwar	Rathore	Mandore → **Jodhpur**
Amber	Kachhwaha	Amber / Jaipur
Bikaner	Rathore branch	Bikaner
Jaisalmer	Bhati	Jaisalmer
Bundi–Kota	Hada	Bundi / Kota

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

1. Do not match **Rana Chunda** with Marwar. The Marwar line uses **Rao** Chunda.
2. **Khanwa** and **Haldighati** are different battles. Khanwa is **1527** (Sanga). Haldighati is **1576** (Pratap).
3. **Man Singh** was not a Sisodia. He was a **Kachhwaha** and the Mughal commander at Haldighati.
4. **Akbar** was not in the Haldighati pass. **Man Singh** commanded the imperial army there.
5. **Jayata** and **Kumpa** belong to **Marwar**, not Mewar.
6. **Udai Singh of Mewar** was not Tansen's patron before Akbar.
7. Do not confuse **Chittor 1303** (Alauddin) with **Chittor 1567–68** (Akbar).
8. **Malik Sarwar** did not found Malwa. He founded **Jaunpur**.
9. **Amar Singh's peace in 1615** was not Pratap's surrender. Pratap had died in **1597**.
10. **Mewar** uses the title **Rana** or **Maharana**. **Marwar** uses **Rao**.
11. In Alauddin's Deccan conquest lists, **Warangal** comes **last**, not first.
12. The fact that **Sanga** had contact with Babur does not mean he stayed allied to him.
13. Do not call Haldighati a clear **Mughal victory**. Say the Mughals held a **strategic edge** on the plains. Pratap survived.

14. **Kumbha** is not Pratap. **Vijay Stambha** was built by Kumbha.
15. **Jaisalmer** comes **before Ranthambore** in Alauddin's extended conquest sequence.
16. **Rana Hammir** of Mewar is not **Hamir Deva** of Ranthambore.
17. **Kirti Stambha** is not **Vijay Stambha**. Kirti is the older Jain tower at Chittor.
18. **Gujarat** → **Ranthambore** → **Chittor** → **Warangal** is the core sequence — option letters differ across papers.

Topic 10 — Sikhism

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Lehna	Sri Chand	Nanak's chosen successor (Angad) vs Nanak's son (not Guru)	लेहना / श्रीचंद
Manji	Masand	Amar Das's 22 preaching circles vs Arjan's tenth collection	मंजी / मसंद
Nanak	Gobind Singh	Founder 1469 vs 10th Guru + Khalsa 1699	नानक / गोबिंद सिंह
Adi Granth	Guru Granth Sahib	Compiled 1604 by Arjan vs eternal Guru after 1708	आदि ग्रंथ / गुरु ग्रंथ साहिब
Harmandir	Akal Takht	Golden Temple (spiritual) vs temporal seat (Hargobind)	हरमंदिर / अकाल तख़्त
Miri	Piri	Temporal sword vs spiritual sword (Hargobind)	मीरी / पीरी
Arjan	Tegh Bahadur	1606 Jahangir vs 1675 Aurangzeb	अर्जुन / तेग बहादुर
Khalsa (Sikh)	Khalsa (Mughal)	1699 initiated Panth vs crown land	सिख खालसा / मुगल खालसा
Mardana	Nanak	Disciple/rababi vs Guru	मर्दाना / नानक
Anandpur	Amritsar	Khalsa 1699 vs Ram Das tank / Harmandir	अनंदपुर / अमृतसर
Hargobind	Gobind Singh	Miri-Piri start vs Khalsa ritual	हरगोबिंद / गोबिंद सिंह
Har Krishan	Gobind Singh	8th child Guru vs 10th last human Guru	हर कृष्ण / गोबिंद सिंह
Dasam Granth	Guru Granth	Gobind Singh corpus vs eternal Guru	दसम ग्रंथ / गुरु ग्रंथ
Panj Pyare	Ten Gurus	First five Khalsa 1699 vs 1469–1708 line	पंज प्यारे / दस गुरु
Langar	Sangat	Community kitchen vs congregation	लंगर / संगत

10.3 Ten Sikh Gurus

#	Guru	Years	One fact
1	**Nanak**	1469–1539	Founder
2	**Angad**	1539–1552	**Gurmukhi**
3	**Amar Das**	1552–1574	Langar; **22 Manjis**; **Goindwal**
4	**Ram Das**	1574–1581	**Amritsar** (Akbar grant / Bibi Bhani)
5	**Arjan Dev**	1581–1606	**Adi Granth 1604**; Masand; martyred **1606**
6	**Hargobind**	1606–1644	**Miri-Piri**; **Akal Takht**
7	**Har Rai**	1644–1661	Kept the armed tradition quietly
8	**Har Krishan**	1661–1664	**Child Guru**; died in **Delhi**
9	**Tegh Bahadur**	1665–1675	Martyred **1675** under **Aurangzeb**
10	**Gobind Singh**	1675–1708	**Khalsa 1699**; Granth eternal

10.6 Guru Gobind Singh

10.7 Master Fact-Locks — Sikh Guru Lineage, Institutions & Geography

Entity / Concept	Canonical Facts & Historical Specifics	High-Yield Exam Lock
1. Guru Nanak Dev (1469–1539)	• Born at **Talwandi (Nankana Sahib)**, Punjab (now Pakistan); died at **Kartarpur**. • Preached *Nirguna Bhakti*, divine unity (*Ik Onkar*), founded the *Sangat* (congregation) and *Pangat / Langar* (free community kitchen). • Selected **Bhai Lehna** as successor, naming him **Angad** (*"limb of my body"*), bypassing his own sons Sri Chand (who founded the ascetic *Udasi* sect) and Lakhmi Das.	Founder of Sikhism
2. Guru Angad (1539–1552)	• Progenitor / developer of the **Gurmukhi script**. • Formalized and expanded the *Langar* institution; compiled Guru Nanak's hymns.	Originator of Gurmukhi
3. Guru Amar Das (1552–1574)	• Divided the spiritual administration into **22 diocese / branches called Manjis**, each headed by a devout Sikh preacher. • Advocated strongly against *Purdah* and *Sati*; visited by Emperor Akbar at Goindwal.	22 Manjis administrative network
4. Guru Ram Das (1574–1581)	• Akbar granted **500 Bighas of land** containing a natural pool to his wife **Bibi Bhani**. • Founded the sacred city of **Ramdaspur**, later renamed **Amritsar** after the sacred pool (*Amrit Sarovar*).	Foundation of Amritsar
5. Guru Arjan Dev (1581–1606)	• Compiled the holy scripture **Adi Granth** in **1604 CE** at Amritsar. • Constructed **Sri Harmandir Sahib** (Golden Temple) in the center of the Amritsar pool; foundation stone laid by Sufi saint Mian Mir. • Founded the cities of **Tarn Taran** and **Kartarpur** (Jalandhar). • Instituted the **Masand system** (requiring Sikhs to contribute one-tenth of their income, *Dasvandh*, to the Guru). • **Martyrdom (1606 CE):** Gave shelter, blessings, and financial support to the rebel prince Khusrau; summoned, fined, and sentenced to execution under torture by Emperor **Jahangir** (first great Sikh martyrdom).	Compilation of Adi Granth & 1st Martyrdom
Adi Granth Composition Details	• Contains sacred hymns of six Sikh Gurus (Nanak, Angad, Amar Das, Ram Das, Arjan Dev, and later Tegh Bahadur). • Includes compositions of 15 Bhakti and Sufi saints: Kabir, Baba Farid, Namdev, Ravidas, Dhanna, Pipa, Sain, Trilochan, Jaidev, Ramananda. • **Earliest poet:** 12th-century Bengali Vaishnava poet **Jayadeva** (author of *Gita Govinda*). • **Chronologically latest hymns:** Added by 10th Guru Gobind Singh from the hymns of **Guru Tegh Bahadur**.	Hymns & syncretic contributors
6. Guru Hargobind (1606–1644)	• Adopted the policy of militarization; wore two swords representing **Miri** (temporal authority) and **Piri** (spiritual authority). • Built the **Akal Takht** (Throne of the Timeless) opposite Harmandir Sahib; fortified Amritsar (*Lohgarh*).	Miri & Piri doctrine
7. Guru Har Rai (1644–1661)	Maintained a standing cavalry; provided medical aid to Prince Dara Shikoh.	Peaceful consolidation
8. Guru Har Krishan (1661–1664)	Acceded as the child Guru (age 5); served smallpox victims in Delhi; passed away at age 8 (*"Bal Guru"*).	Youngest Guru
9. Guru Tegh Bahadur (1664–1675)	• Revered as *Hind di Chadar* (Shield of India). • Protested against Aurangzeb's religious persecution and defended the freedom of Kashmiri Pandits. • Summoned to Delhi, refused conversion to Islam, and was publicly beheaded at **Chandni Chowk, Delhi** in November **1675 CE** on the orders of Emperor **Aurangzeb** (Gurudwara Sis Ganj Sahib marks the martyrdom site; Gurudwara Rakab Ganj marks the cremation site).	2nd Martyrdom (Aurangzeb)

Entity / Concept	Canonical Facts & Historical Specifics	High-Yield Exam Lock
10. Guru Gobind Singh (1675–1708)	• Born in **1666 CE at Patna** (Bihar); fought against hill Rajas (Battle of Bhangani, 1688). • Founded the military order of the **Khalsa Panth** on **Baisakhi (13 April 1699)** at **Anandpur Sahib**. • Mandated the **Five Ks (Kakars):** *Kesh* (uncut hair), *Kangha* (wooden comb), *Kara* (iron bracelet), *Kachhera* (cotton undergarment), *Kirpan* (curved dagger). • Ordained universal surnames: **Singh** (Lion) for men and **Kaur** (Princess) for women. • Composed the Persian epistle ***Zafarnama*** (Epistle of Victory) addressed to Aurangzeb. • Assassinated at **Nanded** (Maharashtra) in 1708 by an Afghan mercenary; his mausoleum is enshrined at **Takhat Sachkhand Sri Hazur Abchalnagar Sahib**. • Declared the termination of human guruship, investing eternal spiritual authority in the **Guru Granth Sahib**.	Khalsa Panth & Nanded Mausoleum
Banda Singh Bahadur (1670–1716)	• Original name: **Lachman Dev** (or Madho Das Bairagi); named Banda Singh Bahadur by Guru Gobind Singh at Nanded. • Led massive peasant rebellion in Punjab, established Sikh sovereignty, struck coins in the names of Guru Nanak and Guru Gobind Singh, abolished the Zamindari system. • Executed at Delhi in 1716 under Emperor Farrukh Siyar.	First Sikh sovereign military leader
Hemkund Sahib	Famous Sikh shrine located at high altitude in **Chamoli district, Uttarakhand**, associated with the pre-incarnation penance of Guru Gobind Singh mentioned in the *Bachittar Natak*.	Sacred Himalayan shrine

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

25. **Lehna = Angad**; **Sri Chand** and **Mardana** are not successors.
26. **Manji** = Amar Das; **Masand tenth** = Arjan; **Miri–Piri** = Hargobind; **Khalsa** = Gobind Singh.
27. **Amritsar** rises from **Akbar's grant** to **Bibi Bhani** / **Ram Das**, not from Nanak or Gobind Singh.
28. **Hem Kund** (UK) ≠ Roop Kund; **Nanded / Hazur Sahib** = Gobind Singh's end.
29. **Banda Bahadur** = **Lachhman Dev**, not Mahesh Das.
30. **Kabir** did not found Sikhism. **Guru Nanak** founded the line.
31. **Mardana** was not Nanak's guru. He was Nanak's disciple.
32. **Guru Nanak** did not create the Khalsa. **Guru Gobind Singh** created it in **1699**.
33. **Sikh Khalsa** of 1699 is not **Mughal Khalsa** crown land — keep the Panth and revenue terms separate.
34. **Guru Arjan** was not executed under Aurangzeb. **Jahangir** ordered his execution in **1606**.
35. **Guru Tegh Bahadur** was not martyred in **1606**. **Aurangzeb** had him executed in **1675**.
36. **Guru Gobind Singh** did not compile the Adi Granth. **Guru Arjan** compiled it in **1604**.
37. The **Dasam Granth** is not the eternal Guru.
38. **Guru Hargobind** did not create the Khalsa. He began **Miri-Piri**.
39. There is **no 11th human Guru**.
40. **Har Krishan** is the **8th** Guru, not the 10th.
41. The Khalsa was created at **Anandpur**, not Amritsar.
42. **1604** and **1606** are different facts. Do not swap compilation and martyrdom.
43. **Adalat-i-Ala** belongs to **Ranjit Singh** at **Lahore**, not to Nanak.
44. Sikhism upholds the **householder** path, not forest **sanyasa**, as the ideal.

Topic 11 — Marathas

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Chauth	Sardeshmukhi	25% protection vs extra 10% chief claim	चौथ / सरदेशमुखी
Shivaji	Peshwa	Chhatrapati founder vs later de facto ruler	शिवाजी / पेशवा
Bajirao I	Balaji Bajirao	Father 1720–40 vs son 1740–61 (Panipat)	बाजीराव I / बालाजी बाजीराव
Madhav Rao I	Narayan Rao	1761–72 recovery vs 1772–73 murdered	माधवराव / नारायणराव
Panipat I	II vs III	1526 Babur / 1556 Akbar–Hemu / 1761 Maratha–Abdali	पानीपत I / II / III
Abdali	Nadir Shah	Panipat 1761 vs Delhi sack 1739	अब्दाली / नादिर शाह
Bhau	Bajirao I	1761 commander vs died 1740	भाऊ / बाजीराव
Raigad	Pune	Shivaji coronation vs Peshwa seat	रायगढ़ / पुणे
Sangola	Lanavada	1750 Peshwa supremacy vs 1718 chauth recognition	सांगोला / लानावड़ा
Chauth	Saranzami	25% protection levy vs jagirdar livelihood land	चौथ / सरंजामी
Deshmukh	Ashtapradhan	Feudal Bijapur chiefs vs Shivaji's 8 ministers	देशमुख / अष्टप्रधान
Purandar	Lanavada	1665 Shivaji–Jai Singh vs 1718 Shahu–Mughals	पुरंदर / लणवाडा
Sambhaji	Shahu	Executed 1689 vs released 1707, Peshwa rise	सम्भाजी / शाहू
Sikh Khalsa	Chauth	1699 Panth vs Maratha 25% levy	खालसा / चौथ

11.3 Administrative Structure of Shivaji — Ashtapradhan

Minister	Also called	Portfolio
Peshwa	Mukhya Pradhan	General administration
Amatya	Majumdar	Finance and accounts
Mantri	Waqia Navis	Chronicle and private records
Senapati	Sar-i-Naubat	Army command
Sumant	Dabir	Foreign affairs
Nyayadhish	—	Chief justice
Panditrao	Pandit Rao	Religion, charity, ritual (कर्मकाण्ड)
Sachiv	Shuru Navis	Correspondence and seal (मुद्रा)

11.4 Revenue — Chauth & Sardeshmukhi

Confused revenue names (do not swap)

Name	What it is	Trap
Chauth (चौथ)	**25%** protection levy	Calling it the hereditary 10%
Sardeshmukhi (सरदेशमुखी)	Extra **10%** sardeshmukh claim	Calling it the protection quarter
Abwab (अबवाब)	Miscellaneous extra cesses	Treating it as Maratha protection revenue
Jamadani	A **textile**	Using it as a revenue term

Name	What it is	Trap
Rakhi (राखी)	Local protection arrangement with chiefs (e.g. Bundelkhand belts)	Equating it with chauth's 25% name
Saranzami (सरंजामी)	Land supporting Maratha **jagirdars'** livelihood	Mixing it with chauth

11.5 Peshwas

Peshwa	Years	Fact
Balaji Vishwanath	1713–1720	First hereditary; **Lanavada 1718**
Bajirao I (Rau)	1720–1740	North expansion; **Palkhed 1728** vs Nizam
Balaji Bajirao (Nana Saheb)	1740–1761	Panipat III generation
Madhav Rao I	1761–1772	Post-1761 recovery
Narayan Rao	1772–1773	Murdered
Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)	1773–1774	After Narayan; Anglo-Maratha (आंग्ल-मराठा) bridge
Baji Rao II	1795–1818	Last Peshwa

11.6 Third Battle of Panipat (14 January 1761)

11.7 Master Fact-Locks — Maratha Polity, Ashtapradhan, Peshwaship & Panipat III

Domain / Concept	Canonical Historical Specifics & Facts	Official Exam Focus
Shivaji's Birth, Coronation & Capital	• Born at the hill fort of **Shivneri** in **1627 CE** (or 1630 CE); died in **1680 CE** at age 53. • Crowned as ***Chhatrapati*** at **Raigad Fort** in **June 1674 CE** by the renowned Banaras theologian **Pandit Vishweshwar (Gaga Bhatt)**, who formally invested him with the sacred thread and proclaimed him a Kshatriya of the Sisodia Rajput lineage. • Made **Raigad** his imperial capital. • **Early Military Sequence:** Fort of Chakan (1648) \rightarrow First clash with Mughals (1657) \rightarrow Slaying of Bijapuri general Afzal Khan with tiger claws (*bagh nakh*) at Pratapgad (1659) \rightarrow Night raid on Shaista Khan at Pune (1663) \rightarrow First sack of Surat (1664) \rightarrow Battle of Salher (1672, decisive Maratha victory over imperial Mughal field army).	Genesis of Maratha Swarajya
Purandar & Agra Escape	• **Treaty of Purandar (June 1665 CE):** Signed between Shivaji and Mughal general **Raja Jai Singh I of Amber**; Shivaji surrendered 23 out of 35 forts (yielding 4 lakh huns revenue), retaining 12 forts (1 lakh huns). • **Agra Captivity (1666 CE):** Imprisoned in **Jaipur Bhawan at Agra** by Aurangzeb; made a dramatic escape inside large fruit and sweet baskets on 17 August 1666.	Diplomatic & strategic landmarks

Domain / Concept	Canonical Historical Specifics & Facts	Official Exam Focus
Ashtapradhan Council of Eight Ministers	Not a cabinet with collective responsibility, but eight departmental heads acting as personal advisors/secretaries to Shivaji (the Chhatrapati could accept or reject any advice): 1. **Peshwa (Mukhya Pradhan):** Prime Minister; general administration, royal welfare. 2. **Amatya (Majumdar):** Finance and Revenue Minister; audited imperial receipts and accounts. 3. **Waqianavis (Mantri):** Interior Minister; intelligence, espionage, court daily proceedings. 4. **Sachiv (Surnavis / Shuru-Nawis):** In-charge of royal correspondence, checked draft firmans. 5. **Sumant (Dabir):** Foreign Minister; diplomatic relations, foreign envoys. 6. **Senapati (Sar-i-Naubat):** Commander-in-Chief; military recruitment, organization, food supply. 7. **Pandit Rao (Danadhyaksha):** High Priest; religious grants, moral conduct, social disputes. 8. **Nyayadhish:** Chief Justice; judicial civil and criminal administration according to Hindu Shastras. *(Note: All ministers except Pandit Rao and Nyayadhish were required to command troops in the field).*	Complete 8-portfolio administrative lock
Currency & Maritime Systems	• Silver coins: **Rupaya**, **Lari** (fish-hook shaped silver wire coin from Persian Gulf / Bijapuri coast), and **Taka**. • **Ruka:** Bronze / copper coin of the South Indian **Kakatiya dynasty**, NOT a Maratha silver coin.	Numismatic distinctions
Saranzami Land Revenue System	Specialized Maratha land assignment system where villages/lands were granted as **Saranzam** to Maratha military commanders (*Saranjamdars* / Jagirdars) for their personal maintenance and the upkeep of their military contingents.	Agrarian military tenure
Chauth & Sardeshmukhi	• **Chauth:** Assessment of **one-fourth (25%)** of standard land revenue levied on non-Maratha territories (*Mughalai*) as protection money against Maratha raids. • **Sardeshmukhi:** Additional levy of **one-tenth (10%)** claimed by Shivaji in his hereditary capacity as supreme head (*Sardeshmukh*) of Maharashtra.	Dual revenue extraction spine
Succession & Regents (1680–1708)	• **Sambhaji (1680–1689):** Eldest son of Shivaji; captured and brutally executed by Aurangzeb at Tulapur. • **Rajaram (1689–1700):** Second son; took refuge at Jinji during Mughal siege; operated as regent for young Shahu. • **Tarabai (1700–1707+):** Widow of Rajaram; crowned her 4-year-old son **Shivaji II**; led fierce Maratha resistance against Aurangzeb, recapturing Sinhagad, Raigad, and Satara. At Aurangzeb's death (1707), Maratha leadership was entirely in her hands. • **Chhatrapati Shahu (1708–1749):** Released by Prince Azam Shah; defeated Tarabai at the **Battle of Khed (1707 CE)**; crowned at Satara.	Royal house evolution
Peshwa Ascendancy & Sangola Agreement	1. **Balaji Vishwanath (1713–1720):** Appointed Peshwa in November 1713 by Shahu; negotiated 1719 treaty with Sayyid brothers (the *"Magna Carta of Maratha Dominion"*). 2. **Bajirao I (1720–1740):** Undefeated cavalry genius; preached northern expansion (*"Strike at the trunk of the decaying tree"*); defeated Nizam at Palkhed (1728), established Maratha confederacy. 3. **Balaji Bajirao / Nana Saheb (1740–1761):** Post of Peshwa became hereditary; capital shifted to Pune. • **Treaty of Sangola (1750 CE):** Chhatrapati Ramraja became a ceremonial titular figurehead (*"Mayor of the Palace"*), and the Peshwa emerged as the de facto sovereign head of the Maratha Confederacy. 4. **Madhavrao I (1761–1772):** Restored Maratha prestige in the North after Panipat; placed Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II back on the Delhi throne in 1772. 5. **Narayanrao (1772–1773):** Murdered in a palace conspiracy orchestrated by his ambitious uncle **Raghunathrao (Raghoba)**.	Hereditary Peshwaship sequence

Domain / Concept	Canonical Historical Specifics & Facts	Official Exam Focus
Third Battle of Panipat (14 January 1761)	• **Combatants:** Maratha army under **Sadashivrao Bhau** (accompanied by young Vishwasrao) vs. Afghan invader **Ahmad Shah Abdali** (Durrani) allied with Rohilla chief **Najib-ud-Daulah (Najib Khan)** and Nawab Shuja-ud-Daula of Awadh. • **Immediate Cause:** Ahmad Shah Abdali sought vengeance against Marathas for expelling his viceroy **Timur Shah** from Lahore in 1758. • **Eyewitness Account:** Chronicler **Kashiraj Pandit** was an eyewitness: "*The Third Battle of Panipat proved catastrophic for the Marathas.*" • **Merchant's Encrypted Message:** "*Two pearls have been dissolved [Bhau and Vishwasrao], 22 gold coins have been lost [prominent sardars], and of the silver and copper the total cannot be cast up.*"	Decisive 18th-century battle
Modi Script	Cursive script developed in Maharashtra; utilized across all official Maratha administrative, judicial, and revenue documents.	Marathi administrative script

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

20. **Salher 1672** = battlefield win vs Mughals; **Purandar 1665** = treaty with Jai Singh.
21. **Gaga Bhatt** = coronation priest; **Ramdas** = guru.
22. **Sangola 1750** (Balaji Bajirao) ≠ **Lanavada 1718** (Balaji Vishwanath).
23. **Tarabai** at Aurangzeb's death; do not pick Sambhaji (already dead) or Ahilyabai.
24. **Kashiraj Pandit** = Panipat III eyewitness; immediate spark = **Timur Shah** expelled from Lahore.
25. **Ruka** is not Shivaji's silver coin; **Modi** script = Maratha papers.
26. **Chauth** and **Sardeshmukhi** are different levies. Chauth is **25%** protection. Sardeshmukhi is an extra **10%**.
27. **Madhav Rao I** ruled **before Narayan Rao**.
28. Some Peshwa chronology lists skip Madhav and place **Raghoba** after Narayan — always read the four names in the stem.
29. **Bajirao I** and **Balaji Bajirao** are different Peshwas.
30. The **Peshwa** was not king in Shivaji's lifetime. He was one of eight ministers.
31. **Shivaji** did not fight at Panipat III. He died in **1680**.
32. **Sadashiv Rao Bhau** commanded at Panipat III. He is not **Bajirao I**.
33. **Ahmad Shah Abdali** won at Panipat in **1761**. That is not **Nadir Shah** in **1739**.
34. **Panipat III** is not Panipat I or II.
35. **Deshmukhs** wanted to remain **Bijapur feudal lords**, not join Shivaji's swaraj.
36. **Raigad** is not **Pune**. Raigad is Shivaji's coronation fort. Pune is the Peshwa seat.
37. **Purandar (1665)** is not **Lanavada (1718)**.
38. **Abwab** and **Jamadani** are not Maratha protection terms.
39. **Sumant** handled foreign affairs. **Amatya** handled finance. Do not swap them.
40. On each Peshwa chronology stem, read **which four names** are in the list. The option letter changes with the list.
41. **Torna / Rajgad / Sinhagad** belong to Shivaji's early rise; do not start his story only at Afzal Khan.
42. **Mastani** is linked to **Bajirao I**, not Balaji Bajirao.

Topic 12 — Later Medieval India

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Blue Water	Cartaze	Almeida's ocean monopoly line vs Portuguese sea-pass fee	ब्लू वॉटर / कार्टाज़
Almeida	Albuquerque	First Viceroy / Blue Water vs real founder / Goa 1510	अल्मेदा / अल्बुकर्क
Levant	EIC 1600	1592 land-route charter vs sea company under Akbar	लेवेंट / ईआईसी
Masulipatnam 1611	Surat 1613	Temporary English factory vs first permanent	मसूलिपत्तनम / सूरत
St. Thome	Wandiwash	1st Carnatic French win vs 1760 British win over Lally	सेंट थॉम / वांडीवाश
Hooghly	Chinsurah	Portuguese piracy base vs Dutch Fort Gustavus	हुगली / चिन्सुरा
Gama	Albuquerque	1498 Calicut vs 1510 Goa	गामा / अल्बुकर्क
Hawkins	Roe	1608 trader-envoy vs 1615–19 ambassador	हॉकिन्स / रो
EIC 1600	VOC 1602	English charter vs Dutch company	ईआईसी / वीओसी
Cartaze	Farman	Portuguese sea-pass vs Mughal grant	कार्टाज़ / फ़रमान
Pondicherry	Tranquebar	French vs Danish	पांडिचेरी / ट्रैंकेबार
Chandernagore	Serampore	French Bengal vs Danish Bengal	चंद्रनगर / श्रीरामपुर
Surat	Madras vs Calcutta	1612 / 1640 / ~1698	सूरत / मद्रास / कलकत्ता
Aix-la-Chapelle	Paris	1748 1st Carnatic vs 1763 Seven Years' War	1748 / 1763
Dupleix	Clive	French Carnatic vs English Arcot/Plassey	डुप्ले / क्लाइव
Bahadur Shah I	Zafar	1707 successor of Aurangzeb vs last Mughal 1837–57	बहादुर शाह I / ज़फ़र
Rangeela	Farrukh Siyar	Muhammad Shah (Peacock Throne / Nadir) vs 1717 Bengal farman	रंगीला / फ़र्रुख़
Sayyid brothers	Zulfiqar Khan	King-makers vs Jahandar's kingmaker	सैय्यद / ज़ुल्फ़िक़ार
Nizam	Saadat Khan	Hyderabad 1724 vs Awadh 1722	निज़ाम / सआदत
5 Observatories (Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi, Mathura)	Non-observatory cities (Agra, Allahabad)	Five cities including Mathura; not Allahabad	जय सिंह
Saadat Khan	Murshid Quli	Awadh 1722 vs Bengal Nawabi	सआदत / मुर्शिद क़ुली
Fitch	Bernier	English 1580s vs French Aurangzeb court	फिच / बर्नियर
1608	1611	Hawkins arrives **1608** vs trap year **1611**	1608 / 1611
Awadh 1722	annex 1856	Nawabi start vs Dalhousie end	1722 / 1856

12.1 European companies — frame

Company	Charter	India
Portuguese	1498 voyage	**Goa 1510** (गोवा)

Company	Charter	India
English EIC	**1600**	**Surat 1612**
Dutch VOC	**1602**	**Pulicat**
Danish	**1616**	**Tranquebar 1620**
French	**1664**	**Pondicherry 1674**

12.9 Independent State of Awadh

12.10 Master Fact-Locks — Disintegration of the Mughal Empire & 18th-Century Successor States

Sovereign / State	Key Historical Specifics & Events	Official Exam Anchors
Bahadur Shah I (Muazzam / Shah Alam I, 1707–1712)	• Eldest surviving son of Aurangzeb; ascended the throne in 1707 at the age of **63** after defeating brothers Azam (Battle of Jajau) and Kam Bakhsh. • Contemporary chronicler Khafi Khan bestowed upon him the famous sobriquet ***'Shah-i-Bekhabar'*** (the Heedless King) due to his lax administration.	Successor to Aurangzeb
Jahandar Shah (1712–1713)	First puppet emperor in Mughal history; ascended the throne with the backing of powerful noble **Zulfiqar Khan**; denounced by contemporaries as ***'Lampat Murkh'*** (the Lewd Moron); defeated and killed by his nephew **Farrukh Siyar** in February 1713.	Shortest early rule
Farrukh Siyar (1713–1719)	• Placed on the throne by the **Sayyid Brothers** (**Abdullah Khan** as Wazir and **Husain Ali Khan** as Mir Bakshi), who became famous across Indian history as the ***'King Makers'***. • **1717 Royal Farman:** Granted the English East India Company duty-free trading privileges (*Dastak*) in Bengal in exchange for a meager annual tribute of **Rs. 3,000** (hailed by Orme as the *"Magna Carta of the Company"*). • Dethroned, blinded, and strangled by the Sayyid brothers in 1719.	Sayyid brothers & 1717 Farman
Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela' (1719–1748)	• Nicknamed ***'Rangeela'*** due to his continuous indulgence in wine, music, animal fights, and court pleasures, leaving imperial governance dominated by a faction of palace women (Koki Jiu) and eunuchs. • **Last emperor to sit on the Peacock Throne (*Takht-i-Taus*)** built by Shah Jahan. • **Nadir Shah's Invasion (1739 CE):** Persian ruler Nadir Shah routed the imperial army at the **Battle of Karnal** (February 1739), entered Delhi, and orchestrated a horrific nine-hour general massacre (*Katl-i-Aam*). Historian Anand Ram Mukhlis recorded that Nadir Shah carried away **Rs. 60,000 in cash, crores in gold coin, the Kohinoor diamond, and the entire Peacock Throne** back to Iran.	Sack of Delhi & Peacock Throne
Shah Alam II (Ali Gauhar, 1759–1806)	Escaped Delhi due to fear of Wazir Imad-ul-Mulk; fought at the Battle of Buxar (1764) and signed the Treaty of Allahabad (1765); restored to Delhi by Mahadji Shinde in 1772; blinded by Afghan chief Ghulam Qadir Rohilla in 1788; lived as a pensioner when the British captured Delhi under **Lord Lake in 1803 CE**.	British occupation of Delhi
Bahadur Shah II 'Zafar' (1837–1857)	• Son of **Akbar II** (r. 1806–1837); proclaimed figurehead leader of the 1857 Revolt; dubbed *"The Emperor without an Empire"*; poet guided by master bards **Sheikh Ibrahim Zauq** and **Mirza Asadullah Khan Ghalib**; spiritual mentor was **Hasan Askari**. • **Pension Terms:** Received **Rs. 1 lakh per month** as direct pension, Rs. 15 lakh for estate revenues, and Rs. 1,000 for regular family expenses. • Exiled to Rangoon (Burma) where he died in **1862 CE**.	Last Mughal Emperor
Proverbial Tughluq Epitaph	The popular satirical Persian couplet *"Sultanat-e-Shah-e-Alam, az Dilli ta Palam"* (*"The empire of the Emperor extends from Delhi to Palam"*) was originally coined for the late 14th-century Tughluq sultan **Nasir-ud-din Mahmud Shah**, reflecting the collapse of imperial authority to the immediate outskirts of the capital.	Historic dynastic proverb
Independent State of Awadh (1722)	Founded by **Saadat Khan (Burhan-ul-Mulk)** in **1722 CE**; belonged to the Irani Shia faction; actively assisted Muhammad Shah in overthrowing the Sayyid brothers; succeeded by nephew Safdarjung.	Awadh dynasty founder

Sovereign / State	Key Historical Specifics & Events	Official Exam Anchors
Independent Kingdom of Hyderabad (1724)	Founded by **Mir Qamar-ud-din Khan (Chin Qilich Khan / Nizam-ul-Mulk)**, head of the Turani noble faction. In October 1724, he decisively defeated and killed the imperial viceroy **Mubariz Khan** at the **Battle of Sakhar-Kherda (Shakar Kheda)** in Berar, after which Muhammad Shah conferred upon him the title ***Asaf Jah***.	Hyderabad dynasty founder
Maharaja Sawai Jai Singh II (1688–1743)	• Kachhwaha Rajput king of Amber; founded the planned city of **Jaipur** in 1727 as a royal center of art, astronomy, and science. • Built **five state-of-the-art astronomical observatories (*Jantar Mantars) at Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Mathura, and Varanasi (did NOT* build one at Allahabad / Prayagraj).** **• *Authored the renowned astronomical observation tables titled*** Zij Muhammad Shahi ***(1733) dedicated to Emperor Muhammad Shah; translated Euclid's*** **Elements of Geometry* into Sanskrit; revived ancient Vedic rituals by performing two** Ashvamedha sacrifices**.	Royal astronomer & Jaipur founder
Origins of 18th-Century Regional States	1. **Mysore Kingdom:** Emerged under the Hindu **Wodeyar dynasty** as an autonomous state out of the disintegration of the southern **Vijayanagara Empire**. 2. **Nizamat of Arcot (Carnatic):** Established under Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb as a legal dependency/subah of Hyderabad, not carved directly out of the state. 3. **Rohilkhand:** Founded by Afghan chieftain **Ali Muhammad Khan** following the breakdown of central authority after Nadir Shah's 1739 invasion (NOT carved by Ahmad Shah Abdali).	Successor states origins matrix

Common Traps — Don't Fall For These

30. **Blue Water** = **Almeida**; **Goa 1510** = **Albuquerque** (not 1499).
31. First fort = **Cochin 1503**; first permanent English factory = **Surat 1613** (Masulipatnam 1611 temporary).
32. **Hooghly** = Portuguese piracy; **Chinsurah** = Dutch; **Serampore** = Danish.
33. **Levant 1592** precedes EIC **1600**; emperor at EIC founding = **Akbar**.
34. Immediate First Carnatic spark = **capture of French ships**; peace = **Aix-la-Chapelle**, not Paris.
35. **Ambur 1749** opens Second Carnatic; **Wandiwash 1760** = Coote beats **Lally**.
36. **Peter Mundy** is English, not Portuguese.
37. **Bahadur Shah I (1707) ≠ Bahadur Shah Zafar (1837–57)**.
38. **1717 farman** = **Farrukh Siyar**, not Akbar or Jahangir.
39. **Peacock Throne / Nadir 1739** = **Muhammad Shah Rangeela**.
40. **Sayyid brothers** = king-makers; **Zulfiqar Khan** backed **Jahandar** only.
41. **Chin Qilich / Nizam ≠ Mubariz Khan**; **Asaf Jah** from **Muhammad Shah**.
42. Jai Singh observatories exclude **Allahabad**; include **Mathura**.
43. Zafar's pension was about **one lakh/month**, not "less than one lakh".
44. **William Hawkins** did not arrive in **1611**. He reached India in **1608**.
45. **Sir Thomas Roe** did not come in **1608**. He served as ambassador in **1615–19**.
46. Among early European travellers, **Ralph Fitch** (1580s) precedes Bernier and Hawkins.
47. **Vasco da Gama** did not take Goa. **Albuquerque** captured it in **1510**.
48. The English EIC charter is **1600**. The Dutch VOC charter is **1602**, not 1600.
49. **Pondicherry** is French. It is not Dutch or Danish.
50. **Tranquebar** is Danish. It is not French.
51. **Serampore** is Danish, not French.
52. **François Bernier** was French, not British.
53. **Aix-la-Chapelle (1748)** is not **Paris (1763)**.

54. **Saadat Khan** founded Awadh. He is not the Bengal Nawab **Murshid Quli Khan**.
55. **Awadh annexation in 1856** came before the **Indigo Revolt of 1859**.
56. The **1600** charter was a trade monopoly. It did not make the EIC ruler of India from day one.
57. **Hawkins** and **Roe** served at **Jahangir's** court, not Akbar's.
58. **Shuja-ud-Daula** of Awadh is not **Shuja** in Aurangzeb's **1658** Banaras fight.

Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Kattyuri Dynasty

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
Imperial State	**Katyuri / Kattyuri Dynasty** (c. **740 CE – 1050 CE**) — 1st historic (ऐतिहासिक) empire of Uttarakhand
First Capital	**Joshimath (Kartikeyapura)** in Alaknanda (अलकनंदा) valley
Second Capital	**Baijnath (Katyur Valley)** on the Gomti river in Bageshwar (बागेश्वर)
Founder Tradition	**Basantandev (Basu Dev)** — titled *Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja (महाराजाधिराज)*
Three Dynastic Houses	1. **Basantandev House** \rightarrow 2. **Nimbar House** \rightarrow 3. **Salonaditya House**
The Unifier King	**Ishtaganadeva** — 1st monarch to politically unify entire Garhwal and Kumaon
Apex Ruler	**Lalitsuradeva** — compared to Varaha and Bhagiratha in Pandukeshwar plates
Key Inscriptions	**Bageshwar Inscription** (Bhuwandev) & **Pandukeshwar Plates** (Lalitsuradeva, Padmata)
Fall of the Dynasty	Last tyrannical king **Bir Dev (Biram Dev)** overthrown by popular peasant rebellion
Branch Successors	Fragmented into **Askot (Rajbar branch), Doti (Raiyka kings), Dwarahat, and Baijnath**
Successor States	**Chand Dynasty** in Kumaon (Champawat (चंपावत)) & **Parmar Dynasty** in Garhwal (Chandpur Garhi)

Katyuri Administrative Structure & Officials

Official Designation	Exact Administrative / Civil Portfolio
Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja	Supreme title of the Katyuri Monarch.
Mahasamanta (महासामंत)	Feudatory tributary prince / senior military commander.
Kottapala	Commander of hill forts, passes, and transit gateways.
Doshaparadhika	High-level investigative officer handling theft, treason, and violent crimes.
Dandapashika / Dandanayaka	Chief Magistrate and punitive executioner.
Bhogika / Mahabhogika	High revenue commissioner collecting agricultural tax (*Bhoga*).
Saulkika	Toll, octroi, and customs collector stationed at valley check-posts.
Tarika / Ghattapala	Officer superintending river ferries, boats, and suspension bridges.
Khadgika	Personal bodyguard to the Emperor armed with the imperial sword.
Pratihara (गुर्जर-प्रतिहार) / Mahapratihara (महाप्रतिहार)	Royal chamberlain regulating court audiences and royal protocol.
Kishorvadhabhikrit	Superintendent of the royal horse-breeding studs and cavalry stables.

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Kartikeyapura vs Brahmapura	Kartikeyapura = **Katyuri capital** (Joshimath \rightarrow Baijnath); Brahmapura = **6th–7th cent. kingdom** described by Hiuen Tsang.
Ishtaganadeva vs Lalitsuradeva	Ishtaganadeva = **The Great Unifier** of Garhwal & Kumaon; Lalitsuradeva = **Most powerful builder/reign** (Pandukeshwar plates).
Bageshwar Inscription vs Pandukeshwar Plates	Bageshwar = Stone epigraph of **King Bhuwandev**; Pandukeshwar = Copper plates of **Lalitsuradeva, Padmata & Subhiksharaja**.

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Bir Dev vs Somchand	Bir Dev = **Last tyrannical Katyuri monarch**; Somchand = **Founder of Chand dynasty** in Kali Kumaon (Champawat).
Kottapala vs Doshaparadhika	Kottapala = **Fort and pass commander**; Doshaparadhika = **Criminal detective/investigator**.

Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Parmar Dynasty of Garhwal

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
Dynasty Name	**Parmar / Panwar** of Garhwal (claimed origin: Malwa Parmars)
Founder Tradition	**Kanakpal** (888 CE legend) at **Chandpur / Chandpurgarh** (Chamoli (चमोली))
Unifier (52 Garhs)	**Ajay Pal** (37th ruler) — shifted capital to **Dewalgarh (1512)** then **Srinagar (1517)**
Standard Measurement	**Dhulia Patha** (grain measure of approx. 2 seers) introduced by Ajay Pal
First "Shah" Title	**Balbhadra Shah** (43rd ruler) — title awarded by Delhi Sultans (Bahlol Lodi contacts)
The "Garh-Bhanjan"	**Mahipat Shah** — Tibet expeditions; commanders Madho Singh Bhandari & Lodi Rikhola
"Nakkati Rani"	**Rani Karnavati** (regent for son Prithvipati Shah) — cut noses of Mughal (मुग़ल) general **Najabat Khan's** army (सेना) (1635)
Painting Origin (1658)	**Shyamdas & Hardas** arrived May 1658 with **Sulaiman Shikoh**; post of **Tasbirdar** (तस्बीरदार) under **Prithvipati Shah**
Later Painting Master	**Mola Ram** (मोला राम) (poet, painter, historian — wrote *Garh-Rajvansh Kavya (काव्य)*)
Fateh Shah & Sikhs	Invited **Guru (गुरु) Ram Rai (राई)** (1676); granted 4 villages: **Khurbura, Rajpur, Chamasari, Dhamawala**; Battle of Bhangani (1688) with Guru Gobind Singh (गुरु गोबिंद सिंह)
Dual Crown King	**Pradyumna Shah** — ruled Kumaon as *Pradyumna Chand*, then returned to Garhwal
Last Independent Ruler	**Pradyumna Shah** died fighting Gorkhas at **Battle of Khudbuda (Dehradun (देहरादून))** on **14 May 1804**

Chronological Ruler Guide & Significant Milestones

King (# / Reign)	Key Contributions & Prelims Hooks
Kanakpal (1st)	Founded dynasty at Chandpur Garh (Chamoli) after marrying daughter of chief Bhanu Pratap (प्रताप).
Ajay Pal (37th, c. 1500–1519)	Consolidated 52 independent garhs. Shifted seat to Dewalgarh (1512), then Srinagar (1517). Devotee of Rajrajeshwari and Gorakhnath; introduced uniform grain measure **Dhulia Patha**.
Sahajpal (42nd (42वां))	Contemporary of Mughal Emperor Akbar (अकबर); Bell inscription at Raghunath Temple, Devprayag (देवप्रयाग) (1561).
Balbhadra Shah (43rd)	First ruler to permanently use the royal surname **Shah** (replacing *Pal*).
Man Shah (44th (44वां संशोधन))	Contemporary of Akbar/Jahangir (जहाँगीर). Poet Bharat wrote *Manodaya Kavya*. Defeated Kumaon's Laxmi Chand in multiple border skirmishes. Founded town of *Manpur*.
Shyam Shah (45th)	Visited Jahangir at Agra (1621), mentioned in *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri* (तुजुक-ए-जहाँगीरी) (gifted horses/elephants). Died childless; 60 queens committed Sati.
Mahipat Shah (46th, 1622–1631)	Titled **Garh-Bhanjan** (Fort Destroyer). Invaded Western Tibet (Chaparang/Daba). Legendary commanders: **Madho Singh Bhandari**, **Lodi Rikhola**, **Banwari Das**. Stopped Kumaon king Trimal Chand.
Rani Karnavati (Regent, 1631–1640)	Wife of Mahipat Shah, regent for minor prince Prithvipati Shah. Defeated Shah Jahan's Mughal invasion led by Najabat Khan (1635) — severed noses of survivors (*Nakkati Rani*). Built *Karanpur* canal and village in Dehradun.
Prithvipati Shah (47th)	Sheltered Prince Sulaiman Shikoh (May 1658). Appointed Shyamdas and Hardas as royal *Tasbirdars* (laid foundation of Garhwal School of Painting).

King (# / Reign)	Key Contributions & Prelims Hooks
Medini Shah (48th)	Opposed father Prithvipati Shah; surrendered Sulaiman Shikoh to Jai Singh (for Aurangzeb). Disowned by father.
Fateh Shah (49th, 1684–1716)	"Golden Age" of culture. Maintained *Navratnas*. Invited Sikh Guru Ram Rai to establish Dera/Gurudwara at Dehradun (1676) with 4 villages (**Khurbura, Rajpur, Chamasari, Dhamawala**). Fought Battle of Bhangani (1688) with Guru Gobind Singh.
Pradeep Shah (1717–1772)	Long peaceful reign. Helped Kumaon's Kalyan Chand IV against the Rohilla invasion (Ali Muhammad Khan, 1744–45) by paying 3 lakh rupees tribute.
Lalit Shah (1772–1780)	Defeated Kumaon king Mohan Chand at **Battle of Bagwali Pokhar (1779)** on invitation of Harsh Dev Joshi; placed son Pradyumna on Kumaon throne as *Pradyumna Chand*.
Jayakrit Shah	Succeeded Lalit Shah in Garhwal; brotherly civil war with Pradyumna; died young.
Pradyumna Shah (54th, 1785–1804)	Abandoned Kumaon to reclaim Garhwal throne. Faced severe famine of 1795 (*Ekanni/Baoni famine*) and massive Garhwal earthquake (1803). Died heroically at **Battle of Khudbuda (Dehradun)** on **14 May 1804** fighting Gorkha forces under Amar Singh Thapa.

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Kanakpal vs Ajay Pal	Kanakpal is the **legendary founder** (Chandpurgarh); Ajay Pal is the **great unifier of 52 Garhs** (Srinagar).
Dewalgarh vs Srinagar	Ajay Pal first moved seat from Chandpur to Dewalgarh (1512), then permanently to Srinagar (1517).
Rani Karnavati vs Tilu Rauteli	Rani Karnavati = Parmar Queen regent / *Nakkati Rani* (1635 Mughal clash); Tilu Rauteli = 17th-century Garhwali folk warrior heroine fighting Katyuris/Rohillas.
Battle of Bhangani vs Battle of Khudbuda	Bhangani (1688) = Fateh Shah vs Guru Gobind Singh; Khudbuda (1804) = Pradyumna Shah vs Gorkha army (Gorkha takeover).
Fateh Shah village grants	True set: **Khurbura, Rajpur, Chamasari, Dhamawala**. Trap distractors: *Chhayawala, Bhujanwala, Panditwari*.

Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Chand Dynasty of Kumaon

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
Dynasty Name	**Chand** dynasty of Kumaon (emblem: **Garud**)
Founder	**Somchand** (c. 10th/11th cent. legend from Jhusi/Prayag (प्रयाग)) at **Champawat (चंपावत) (Rajbunga Fort)**
Four (चातुर्याम) Fort Guards	**Char Aal** clans: **Karki, Bora (बोरा), Taragi (Tadagi), Chaudhary** (UKPCS 2025 Q70)
First Sultanate Contact	**Garud Gyan Chand** (1374–1419) — visited Firoz Shah (फ़िरोज़ शाह) Tughlaq (फिरोज शाह तुगलक); granted Terai (तराई) & title *Garud*
12-Year War Hero	**Bharti Chand** (1437–1477) — ended tributary submission to Doti (Nepal); origin of *Nayak caste*
Capital Shift to Almora (अल्मोड़ा)	**Balo Kalyan Chand** (1560–1568) — completed shift to Almora in **1563** (Alamnagar/Rajapur)
Contemporary of Akbar (अकबर)	**Rudra Chand** (1568–1597) — met Akbar at Lahore (1588); built **Malla Mahal (महाल)**; social rules (*Chauthani*)
Tibet Conqueror / Pilgrimages	**Baz Bahadur Chand** (1638–1678) — conquered Taklakot fort; protected Kailash-Mansarovar; *Ghyoo-kar*
"Golden Age" of Kumaon	**Jagat Chand** (1708–1720) — conquered Garhwal (Srinagar); donated Srinagar tax to Badrinath (बद्रीनाथ)
"Tughlaq of Kumaon"	**Devi Chand** (1720–1726) — eccentric financial waste, squandered treasury
Rohilla Invasion (1743–44)	**Kalyan Chand IV** — invaded by Ali Muhammad Khan; Almora sacked; aided by Garhwal king Pradeep Shah
Kingmaker / "Warwick"	**Harsh Dev Joshi** — played rival factions; invited Lalit Shah and later Gorkhas to Kumaon
Last Ruler & End	**Mahendra Chand** — defeated by Gorkhas at **Battle of Hawalbagh** in **January 1790**
Tax Structure	**36 Rakam 32 Kalam** (36 taxes, 32 administrative cesses)

Chronological Ruler Guide & Significant Milestones

Detailed Ruler Profiles

Ruler	Specific Historical & Prelims Details
Somchand	Founder of dynasty. Built **Rajbunga Fort** at Champawat. Established rural local government: appointed **Burha** and **Sayana** (village elders/heads), Panchayats, and the **Char Aal** military guard clans.
Garud Gyan Chand (1374–1419)	First Chand ruler to establish diplomatic contact with Delhi Sultanate (Firoz Shah Tughlaq). Conferred the title **Garud**; made the eagle his royal heraldic seal (मुद्रा). Wrested Terai-Bhabhar from nomadic plundering.
Bharti Chand (1437–1477)	Launched an epic **12-year war** against the Raiyka kings of Doti (Nepal) to abolish tributary subjugation. Prolonged soldier camps on the frontier led to temporary liaisons, giving birth to the distinct **Nayak caste**.
Rudra Chand (1568–1597)	Contemporary of Akbar. Traveled to Lahore (1588) to pay homage and assist the imperial army against Afghan rebels. Rewarded with the revenue of 84-Mal (Terai). Built **Malla Mahal** fort in Almora. Codified strict caste rituals: categorized Brahmins into **Chauthani** (highest: Joshi, Pant, Pandey, Tiwari) and **Pitiya/Panchbidiya**; appointed **Oliya** Brahmins to predict rain/hailstorms.
Laxmi Chand (1597–1621)	Noted for attacking Parmar Garhwal (ruled by Man Shah) 7 times and suffering defeat each time; claimed a minor frontier post on the 8th try (popularly mocked as *Lakhuli Bidal* / timid cat). Built **Lakshmeshwar Garden** and Nur-Bagh. Established two central courts: **Vali** (for high civil disputes) and **Dungi** (military/common court).

Ruler	Specific Historical & Prelims Details
Baz Bahadur Chand (1638–1678)	Contemporary of Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb. Aided Khalilullah Khan in the Mughal Garhwal campaign (1655). Conquered **Taklakot (Tibet)**, freed the Bhotia merchants, and levied **Ghyoo-kar** (ghee tax) on Tibet trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) to finance *Dharmashalas* for Kailash pilgrims. Installed the historic (ऐतिहासिक) Nanda Devi deity at Almora Fort.
Jagat Chand (1708–1720)	Reigned during the apex of peace and prosperity ("Golden Period" of Chand history). Invaded Garhwal, captured capital Srinagar, forced king Fateh Shah to flee into the hills, and assigned the revenues of Srinagar to the Badrinath shrine.
Devi Chand (1720–1726)	Called the **Muhammad bin Tughlaq (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक) of Kumaon** due to fanciful military ambitions, lavish grants to sycophants, and a failed project to establish control over Delhi.
Kalyan Chand IV (1730–1747)	Sacked by Rohilla Afghan commander **Ali Muhammad Khan** in 1743–1744. Almora temples were plundered. Rescued by Garhwal king Pradeep Shah, who paid the Rohillas 3 lakh rupees to secure their withdrawal.
Mahendra Chand (1788–1790)	The 62nd and final independent Chand monarch. In January 1790, two Gorkha armies under Amar Singh Thapa, Joga Malla, and Hastidal Chautariya crushed him at **Hawalbagh** near Almora.

Chand Administration & The "36 Rakam 32 Kalam" Tax Matrix

The Famous "36 Rakam 32 Kalam" (High-Yield Factual Ratta)

Tax Name (*Rakam*)	Exact Nature of Tax / Obligation
Sirtee (Sirtaan)	Primary cash tax levied on agricultural land; paid by *Sirtaan* tenants.
Jhoolia	Tax levied for crossing rivers on suspension/rope bridges (*Jhoota*).
Mangya	Emergency tax or war levy demanded during wartime or state crisis.
Bhent	Customary tribute, gifts, and offerings presented to the King, princes, or visiting officials.
Ghyoo-kar	Tax levied on milk-producers, paid in clarified butter (ghee); formalized by Baz Bahadur Chand.
Sahu	Tax or fee paid for the royal record-keepers and scribes.
Ratan	Remuneration fee levied to support court astrologers, royal purohits, and almanac makers.
Kukhyalo	Cess imposed on rural families keeping poultry and birds.
Bajad / Bajari	Professional tax levied on weavers, blacksmiths, and artisans.
Tand-kar	Specific tax on handloom (हथकरघा) weaving frames (*Tand*).
Mijhari	Tax levied on low-caste labourers, leather workers, and craftsman households.
Khor-Dungar	Pasture and forest grass-grazing tax.
Ghodiyalo	Tax for the maintenance and fodder of royal cavalry horses.
Kameen-chari / Sayana-chari	Commission cess collected from cultivators to pay the hereditary *Kameen* and *Sayana* officers.

Architectural Heritage & Forts of the Chands

Fort / Monument	Location	Built By / Historical Significance
Rajbunga Fort	Champawat	Built by founder **Somchand**; site of the **Char Aal** gates.
Khagmara Fort	Almora (eastern ridge)	Built by **Bhishm Chand** in early 16th century during early capital transit.
Malla Mahal Fort	Almora (central hill)	Built by **Rudra Chand**; later seat of royal administrative power.
Lalmandi Fort (Fort Moira)	Almora	Built by **Kalyan Chand** (1588); renamed *Fort Moira* by British in 1815.
Netra Garh Fort	Almora	Built on high mountain peak for military reconnaissance.

Fort / Monument	Location	Built By / Historical Significance
Baleshwar Temple Complex	Champawat	Reconstructed and heavily endowed by multiple Chand kings (Garud Gyan Chand, Vikram Chand).

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Somchand vs Kanakpal	Somchand = **Chand Kumaon** founder; Kanakpal = **Parmar Garhwal** founder.
Char Aal vs Char Dham	Char Aal = **4 fort-guard clans** (Karki, Bora, Taragi, Chaudhary); Char Dham = **4 holy shrines** (Badrinath, Kedarnath, Gangotri, Yamunotri).
Garud Gyan Chand vs Baz Bahadur Chand	Garud Gyan Chand visited **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (Delhi Sultanate); Baz Bahadur Chand allied with **Shah Jahan / Aurangzeb** (Mughals).
Hawalbagh vs Khudbuda	Hawalbagh (1790) = Gorkha conquest of **Kumaon (Chands)**; Khudbuda (1804) = Gorkha conquest of **Garhwal (Parmars)**.
Sirtee vs Jhoolia	Sirtee = **cash agriculture tax**; Jhoolia = **rope bridge crossing tax**.